

The Tantra Called the Examination of the Tathāgata, Arhat, Perfectly Awakened Buddha, King of Radiant Splendor, Purifier of All Lower Destinies

Sarvadurgatirapariśodhana Tejorāja Tathāgatārhat Samyaksambuddhasya Kalpa · Toh 483 · Derge Kangyur

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གཟུངས་ཀྱི་

Toh 483 in the Kangyur is a tantric text known in Sanskrit as the Sarva-durgati-pariśodhana-tejorāja-tathāgatārhat-samyaksambuddhasya-kalpa and in Tibetan as the Dé zhin shekpa dra chompa yangdakpar dzokpé sangyé ngenso tamché yongsu jongwa zibriyé kyi... — rendered in English as "The Tantra Called the Examination of the Tathāgata, Arhat, Perfectly Awakened Buddha, King of Radiant Splendor, Purifier of All Lower Destinies." It is a ritual tantra concerned with the purification of beings from the lower realms of rebirth, drawing on the power and radiance of a specific transcendent buddha figure to cleanse negative karma and free sentient beings from unfortunate destinies. The text opens in the manner of a sūtra, with the Buddha residing in a celestial grove of great magnificence surrounded by divine assemblies, suggesting a blending of sūtra-style framing with tantric content and practice. As Toh 483 in the Kangyur, it belongs to the tantric section of the canon and is associated with the broader Sarva-durgati-pariśodhana cycle, a well-known corpus of kriyā or caryā tantra literature devoted to funerary rites, purification, and the liberation of beings from lower existences.

In the Indian language: Sarva-durgati-pariśodhana-tejorāja-tathāgatārhat-samyaksambuddhasya-kalpa-nāma.

In the Tibetan language: The Tantra Called the Examination of the Tathāgata, Arhat, Perfectly Awakened Buddha, King of Radiant Splendor, Purifier of All Lower Destinies. The First Fascicle.

Homage to glorious Vajrasattva.

Thus did I hear. At one time, the Blessed One dwelt in the supremely delightful grove of all the assemblies of gods, a place adorned with jewels, gold, golden trees with their branches and creepers, sala trees, medicinal plants, and flowers — lotus blossoms, blue water-lilies, karṇikā, bakkula, tilaka, aśoka,

māndārava, and great māndārava, and many other varied blossoms — and with wish-fulfilling trees (kalpataru); adorned with silk banners of many kinds; resounding with the sweet calls of many varied birds; filled with the sounds of drums, small drums, cymbals, flutes, conch shells, and many other instruments; where Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), Brahmā, and other gods and divine maidens of every kind took their delight; and where all the buddhas and bodhisattvas had bestowed their blessing.

There, in the midst of that great assembly, the Great Brahmā was seated on a lotus throne. He entered into the meditative absorption called the Purification of All Streams of Lower Destinies. Then, from the hair-tuft (ūrṇā) at the brow of that very same bodhisattva's meditative absorption called Liberation from the Streams of the Three Lower Destinies, there streamed forth a great garland of many rays of light, expanding and gathering. Those rays illuminated all the world-realms of this great trichiliocosm without exception.

Having illuminated them, the minds of all sentient beings were freed from the bonds of mental affliction, and each attained their own happiness. Having illuminated all the delightful groves, he made manifest veneration through clouds of varied offerings. Having circumambulated a hundredfold a thousandfold, and prostrated with his head a hundredfold a thousandfold, he placed an immaculate jewel before the Blessed One and spoke these words:

How wonderful, O Buddha! O Buddha!

How wonderful the deeds of the Buddha!

For you have purified us from the lower destinies
and established us in the conduct of awakening.

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, circumambulated the Blessed One a hundredfold a thousandfold, prostrated, and addressed the Blessed One with these words:

Blessed One, by virtue of what cause did the rays of the Buddha's light, by illuminating everything, bring liberation from the streams of the lower destinies...

and established on the path of complete liberation — how wonderful, O Blessed One! How wonderful, O Sugata!

The Blessed One declared: "Lord of the gods, this is not so very wonderful. Lord of the gods, this is not so very wonderful — for the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have perfectly gathered accumulations of merit beyond measure. Lord of the gods, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas have become

the source of precious qualities beyond measure. Lord of the gods, the perfectly and completely awakened buddhas have perfectly and completely mastered skillful means beyond measure. Lord of the gods, the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have accumulated wisdom beyond measure. The conduct of the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, is beyond measure. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, have made beings beyond measure into fit vessels. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are endowed with wisdom unequalled and equal to the unequalled. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are endowed with miraculous powers unequalled and equal to the unequalled. The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, are endowed with the power of aspiration unequalled and equal to the unequalled. Therefore, lord of the gods, know that the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, work for the benefit of sentient beings according to their capacity as vessels, work for the benefit of sentient beings according to how they are to be trained, and work for the benefit of sentient beings according to their inclinations. Entertain no doubt, no wavering, no uncertainty about this. There is no situation in which the Tathāgatas cannot tame."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, rose from his seat, made a grand and extensive offering to the Blessed One, prostrated, and addressed the Blessed One with these words: "May I, Blessed One, please grant me the courage to work solely for the benefit of all sentient beings, to feel tenderness toward all sentient beings, to be one who is tender-hearted, to be one who possesses great tenderness, and to bring all intentions to complete fulfilment. O Blessed One, please grant me this courage. O Sugata, please grant me this courage. Blessed One, from this very heaven of the Thirty-Three gods, a divine youth called Jewel of Stainless Light has died and passed on. He has exceeded his time and is now seven years old. Blessed One, where has he been reborn? What pleasures and sufferings will he experience? Blessed One, please give a prophecy. O Sugata, please give a prophecy."

The Blessed One declared: "Lord of the gods, if you know that the right moment has come, then listen." The lord of the gods said: "Blessed One, now is the moment. O Sugata, now is the time and the occasion."

The Blessed One declared: "Lord of the gods, that divine youth called Jewel of Stainless Light has died and passed from here and has been born in the great Avīci hell. Having experienced terrible and unbearable suffering there for twelve thousand years, he will then experience suffering in the lesser hells for ten thousand years. After that he will experience suffering in the realms of animals and hungry ghosts for ten thousand years. He will then be born as a

human being in a remote border region, dull-witted, deaf, and mute by nature, with unclear speech, and will experience suffering for sixty thousand years. For eighty-four thousand years he will be tormented by festering wounds oozing pus and blood, by leprosy and eye disease, scorned by the many, abandoned by all,

being born into a lowly lineage, experiencing suffering and transmitting it to others, harming others, creating all manner of karmic obscurations without respite, and beyond that, experiencing suffering upon suffering in an unbroken chain, again and again. Upon hearing this, Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods) and all the other sons of the gods were filled with profound distress and terror, and overcome with sorrow, they fell face-down upon the ground. Then they rose once more and spoke these words: "Blessed One, how will this being be liberated from this unbroken transmission of great suffering? O Sugata, how shall liberation be found? Blessed One, we beseech you to protect this being so that it may be completely freed from this mass of suffering. O Sugata, we beseech you to protect this being."

The Blessed One declared: "Lord of the gods, this teaching has been expounded by eighty-four million buddhas, and I too shall expound it — listen well."

Then Śakra, lord of the gods, again made abundant offerings to the Blessed One with mādārava flowers and great mādārava flowers, with flowers of many kinds, with jeweled crowns, with bracelets, armlets, earrings, necklaces, anklets, and all manner of splendid ornaments, circumambulating him hundreds and thousands of times and prostrating, and he pleased the Blessed One by saying: "Excellent, Blessed One! Excellent, Sugata!" Then he made this request: "Blessed One, for the benefit and happiness of the world with its gods, and so that sentient beings in future times may be fully liberated from the three lower realms, please teach this well. O Sugata, please teach this well."

Then Brahmā and the many other gods likewise spoke with one voice: "Blessed One, excellent! Sugata, excellent! So that sentient beings in future times, by merely hearing the name of this teaching, may be freed from the path of the three lower realms, be born in the fortunate realms of gods or of humans, and attain unsurpassed, perfect, and complete awakening — please teach this."

Then the Blessed One, in order to bless Śakra, Brahmā, and all those sons of the gods by means of the essence of all Tathāgatas, entered into meditative absorption called "The Indestructible Blessing of the Vajra, Certain and Unfailing." Then from within his very heart he drew forth this mantra and blessed those gods with the samaya:

Om sarva vidyā vajra adhiṣṭhāna jñāna samaya hūṃ.

Having thus entered into meditative absorption, and having blessed them through the indestructible vajra blessing that is certain and unfailing, he then drew forth from within his own heart this essence of all Tathāgatas known as the King Who Thoroughly Purifies All Lower Realms:

Om śodhani śodhani sarva pāpaṃ viśodhane, śuddhe viśuddhe, sarva karma āvaraṇa viśuddhe svāhā.

The very moment this great vidyā was proclaimed, all the bonds of the lower-realm continuum for all sentient beings were completely severed. All lower rebirths were thoroughly purified. Unbearable sufferings were utterly pacified, and the multitude of beings came to be endowed with happiness.

Then he further proclaimed this secret essence:

Om śodhane śodhane, om sarva apāya na, sarva sattvebhyo hūṃ.

"Lord of the gods, this too is the essence of all Tathāgatas:

Om sarva apāya viśodhane hūṃ phaṭ.

"Lord of the gods, this too is the essence of all Tathāgatas and the near-essence:

Om traṭ.

"Lord of the gods, this too is the essence that thoroughly purifies all lower realms:

Hūṃ."

"Lord of the gods, moreover, in brief, this is what even the mere recollection of which easily liberates sentient beings of little merit from every thread of lower rebirth:

Namo bhagavate sarva durgati pariśodhana rājāya, tathāgatāya, arhate samyaksaṃbuddhāya. Tadyathā: Om śodhane śodhane, sarva pāpaṃ viśodhane, śuddhe viśuddhe, sarva karma āvaraṇa viśuddhe svāhā.

"This is the root essence.

Oṃ sarvavid sarva āvaraṇa viśodhaya hana hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ sarvavid hūṃ. Oṃ sarvavid phaṭ. Oṃ sarvavid a. Oṃ sarvavid trāṭ. Oṃ sarvavid oṃ. Oṃ sarvavid sva. Oṃ sarvavid a. Oṃ sarvavid hūṃ. Oṃ sarvavid treṭ. Oṃ śa. Oṃ bha.

"Lord of the gods, whoever — any son or daughter of good family — merely hears the name of this secret essence of the Resplendent King, the Tathāgata who thoroughly purifies all lower realms, or holds it in mind, or recites it, or writes it and then wears it upon their head, at the crown, upon their shoulder, or about their neck — for that person, in this very life, neither the eight untimely deaths nor dream-visions connected with the eight untimely deaths, nor any omen associated with lower rebirths, shall arise even in a dream. As for one who properly enters the maṇḍala, receives empowerment, recites the essence, and meditates on the meaning of the mantra — what need is there even to speak of that? No wrongdoing whatsoever shall come near to them, and they shall not go to the lower realms.

"Whether it be a man, a woman, a god, a nāga, a yakṣa, a rakṣasa, an animal, a hungry ghost, a hell-being, or any other being whatsoever — if the body of one who has died is placed within the maṇḍala and empowerment is conferred, then even if that being has been reborn in a hell realm, they shall be immediately liberated and reborn among the race of gods. Having been born in that divine lineage, they shall directly realize the nature of reality of all Tathāgatas, render service and homage to all Tathāgatas, and become irreversible. Their stream of being shall become definite. They shall be born in the lineage of the Tathāgatas. Having thoroughly abandoned all obscurations, they shall come to experience happiness in the lineage of all Tathāgatas, in the lineage of the gods, or in whatever other birth is fitting.

"Lord of the gods, in brief, they shall come to experience all benefit and happiness, both worldly and supramundane."

Then Śakra, the Lord of the Gods (Indra, king of the gods), circumambulated the Blessed One, prostrated before him, and spoke thus: "Blessed One, please speak for the benefit and happiness of those who have fallen under the power of all lower realms, so that those sentient beings may turn their backs upon every lower realm and easily realize unsurpassable, perfectly complete awakening. Lord, please speak. Please, speak."

Then the Blessed One, Śākyamuni, entered into the meditative absorption called the Vajra of Wisdom that Thoroughly Purifies All Lower Realms of All

Tathāgatas, and proclaimed this great maṇḍala called the Resplendent King,
the Thoroughly Purifying of All Lower Realms of All Tathāgatas:

The awakening mind of all buddhas,
the realization of the unsurpassable —
whatever wisdom the Victor has proclaimed,
that, it is said, is the very heart of the maṇḍala.

Then again, the Blessed One, out of compassion for all sentient beings,
proclaimed this outer maṇḍala:

Temples and pleasure groves,
stūpas, divine halls, and the like —
through the correct ritual procedure,
begin by consecrating the site with blessing.

In that site thus blessed,
draw the outer maṇḍala.
It is square with four gates,
adorned with four archways,
a garland of four stairways,
and decorated with lions, elephants, and bulls.
Adorned with silks, bells, pendant streamers and garlands,
with small bells and tassels.
Adorned with vajras, jewels, and lotuses,
and with the mudrā of crossed vajras.
Adorned with eight cords
and the outer door-frames.
Of the nine divisions,
gates and door-frames shall be three divisions each,
and the lines shall be drawn with vajra cords.

Draw the central maṇḍala's lines
to resemble the wheel of Dharma,
with a hub and sixteen spokes,
and of three tiers —
the spokes shall be doubled.

In the central direction, draw Sarvavid (the All-Knowing One),
white as a conch and like the moon of Kunda flowers,
four-faced, seated upon a lion throne of vajra,
bearing the mudrā of meditative absorption,

adorned with all ornaments.

Before him, draw the King who purifies all lower realms,
his two hands folded in the manner of meditative absorption,
of the color of the full moon and of a lotus,
perfectly complete with all ornaments,
the space filled with supreme royal beings.

Behind him, draw the Lord of the Śākya clan,
the chief Sage, Śākyamuni.

In all the corner directions to the left and right,
draw the two supreme royal jeweled flowers:
Locana and Māmakī,
and likewise White Tārā,
each bearing the insignia of their respective family.

Within all the spokes, throughout,
draw in proper sequence
the foremost bodhisattvas such as Vajrasattva and others,
and the bodhisattvas of great miraculous power.

The skilled artist shall draw the offering goddesses
Lāsyā and the rest in the corner directions.
In all the directions of the gates, draw the four gate-keepers.
In the porticoes of all the archways, draw Maitreya and the rest.

All the victorious śrāvakas,
and likewise the foremost solitary buddhas,
and the wrathful ones, messengers, and envoys —
draw these, or write their names.

Outside the outer maṇḍala, draw the four continents.
In Jambudvīpa, draw Brahmā.
In the northern direction, draw the Great Lord (Śiva).
In the eastern and western continents,
draw Śakra (Indra) with all his desires,
together with his retinue.

All the others likewise:
the asuras, gandharvas, and garuḍas,
yakṣas, rākṣasas, and great serpents,

elemental spirits, hungry ghosts, and demons,
nāgas, kumbhāṇḍas, and mountain spirits,
and the four great kings — draw them all.

The planets, stars, and comets,
the wrathful, inauspicious, and harmful
obstructors (vighnāntakas) and vināyakas,
the great sages of good fortune who bring benefit to all sentient beings,
the pramathas and women —
draw them, and likewise the sisters who are yoginīs,
and the great gods of the four elements,
those dwelling in houses and on mountains,
in forests, pleasure groves, and the like,
those dwelling in charnel grounds and in cities —
write their names and symbols,
or draw their spheres.

Then the skilled artist shall place upon the maṇḍala:
fluttering victory banners,
parasols, fly-whisks with five tails,
offering pendants, and various food offerings,
golden birds — eight or sixteen or more —
and five vases filled with the precious water of empowerment.

Lamps, tormas offerings, vases,
and beautiful food offerings shall be placed there;
food and drink well prepared,
and various furnishings set in place.
Various tormas offerings of many kinds shall be set out
as food for the yakṣas and rākṣasas.
Likewise for elemental spirits, nāgas,
humans, and non-humans:
various flowers and fragrances,
milk, butter, and molasses,
and a victorious vase fully filled
with perfumed water shall be placed there.

Then, having bathed and performed the preparatory rites, the vajra master,
adorned with fragrance and a garland of the finest flowers, his mouth fragrant

with perfumed breath, and beautifully adorned, enters and sits facing the door holding flowers in hand.

The chief retinue — the many assemblies of the Victors and their bodhisattva heirs — are then invited. Endowed with mudrā and mantra, the yoga of the hook (ankuśa) and the rest is performed. Reciting "Jaḥ Hūṃ Baṃ Hoḥ — Lord of Compassion, come forth!" the secret binding is applied: with the two index fingers shaped into a hook mudrā, then joined as a lasso, then formed into the manner of a chain, and with the two thumbs bent inward — when moved, they come under one's power.

Then, when the signs arise and satisfaction is expressed, the beginningless and endless is directly perceived. One makes excellent offerings with the finest arghya water, with secret and further offerings, with melodious praise in song, and with the supreme and sublime ritual substances of the gods.

Then the torma (ritual offering) for all elemental spirits shall be made. Examine attentively those who dwell in the directions, those tormented by hunger and thirst. The torma for them shall be made in the appropriate manner.

Then the mantra practitioner shall ripen the disciples fully in the ground of unsurpassed awakening. In order to bring benefit to beings and to swiftly reach awakening, the disciples shall be led to generate the supreme awakening mind (bodhicitta). They shall be blessed, and aspirational prayers for awakening shall be established for them. The profound and vast Dharma shall be proclaimed. Having been protected and dwelling in the vow of ascetic discipline, they shall be led to recite mantra from the lips of the supremely peaceful one.

With silk and other cloth the two eyes are covered. The two hands are placed in the lotus gesture of the glorious vajra holder. Adorned with flowers, jewels, and the like, with the hands filled with honorarium, they shall be led in.

The mantras are these:

Oṃ vajra adhiṣṭha hūṃ. Oṃ vajra samaya hūṃ. Oṃ vajra praveśa hūṃ. A same tri same mahā samaye hūṃ.

Then, with these mantras, flowers and the like shall be cast.

In order to attain the siddhis of buddhahood,
may the great chief who brings benefit to beings
think of me with loving care

and accept these with the thought of healing.

Oṃ vajra pratigṛhṇa hūṃ. Oṃ vajra pratīccha vajra samaya stvaṃ.

Whatever flowers, jewels, and the like fall —
the deity of the family upon whom they land —
if one accomplishes the principal of that family,
siddhi will come, without any doubt.

Then the skilled mantra practitioner shall bestow the sacred commitment (samaya) with this mantra:

Oṃ vajra samaya hūṃ phaṭ.

Then the mudrā of the family is bound at the heart, and the mantra for establishing the deity of the sacred commitment within the heart is:

Oṃ vajra samaya hr̥dayaṃ me praveśa dṛḍha tiṣṭha hūṃ.

Then the sacred commitment shall be proclaimed with these words:

This is your water of hell —
if you transgress the sacred commitment, it burns.
If you uphold the sacred commitment,
siddhi is accomplished through this water of vajra ambrosia.
But if you transgress the sacred commitment,
you are immediately summoned and depart.
The victorious vajra holder, enraged,
destroys seven generations of your lineage.

Therefore, child, you must always
guard with utmost devotion
the sacred commitments proclaimed by the Victors,
the vows, and the words of the guru.

You shall not kill living beings.
You shall not take what is not given.
Lying and engaging in sensual misconduct —
these must not be done by one who desires siddhi.
You shall not drink alcohol,
nor eat meat and the like.
Acts that harm sentient beings
must never be undertaken.

You shall never entirely abandon the Three Jewels.

At all times: the awakening mind,

the essence mantra, mudrā,

the deity and the guru — likewise.

Whatever sins and the like there may be,

you shall not transgress the guru's word.

Offerings made to the deity — do not step on their remnants

nor tread on their shadow.

The same applies to images bearing mudrā —

do not revile mantra or deity.

Do not engage in harmful spirit-working rites and the like.

Do not revile non-Buddhist adherents (tīrthikas).

In brief, do not be of two minds, doubting and uncertain.

One's own suchness, and mantra and the rest — it is likewise the same.

Having taken the vow with firm and unwavering devotion, Sarvavid (the

All-Knowing) bestows empowerment (abhiṣeka) exactly as prescribed. Using

as many vases and the like as there are available, the ten masters each confer

whichever of the ten empowerments they wish. Thereupon, a bell and a vajra

are placed in the hand, along with the wheel and the rest of the seven

precious articles. This is the empowerment conferring the sovereignty of a lord

of men, and it is to be given for the destruction of misdeeds. To a devoted

disciple for the accomplishment of mantra, the mantra master is to give full

instruction in the word. That disciple too, with devotion, pays homage with the

crown of the head, and if they have wealth, they are to present it to the guru.

Wealth, treasure, grain, goods, and gold; mounts, home, bedding, sons and

daughters; men and women too; villages and towns — likewise whatever is

desired — with their own mind filled with trust and faith, they are to offer it as

the supreme gift, truly offering it. For swift accomplishment, with devotion to

the guru, in brief, one's own body too is to be offered.

All the happiness of this life without remainder,

the supreme happiness of future worlds,

and even buddhahood itself shall be attained —

what need then to speak of the happiness of the gods?

Equal to all buddhas is the vajra master (vajrācārya).

If one holds him in contempt,

one will perpetually encounter suffering —
therefore one must not show even the slightest disrespect.

Toward vajra brothers and sisters,
and toward the vajra consorts themselves,
a yogin must not be contemptuous,
and must never harbor ill will.

Toward those who harm the Three Jewels,
who revile the guru and are hostile,
who have transgressed their sacred vow,
and those who commit similar wrongs —
one is not to cultivate patience.
If one acts accordingly, Sarvavid
has declared that one will obtain attainments (siddhis),
and with compassion for all sentient beings
one will attain the loving-kindness attainment.

Thereupon the Blessed One proclaimed this sādhana rite for the benefit and welfare of Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, together with the divine world, and for the sake of their benefit and happiness.

On cloth one is to paint the Blessed One Sarvavid exactly as described. To the right is to be the Tathāgata Sarvaduṛgatipariśodhana Tejaḥrāja — the King of Splendor, Purifier of All Lower Realms. To the left is Śākyamuni. Directly below the Purifier of All Lower Realms is Avalokiteśvara, sovereign of vision — moon-white in color, holding a lotus in his hand. Below Śākyamuni is Vajrapāṇi. Between those two is the Medicine Master — lapis blue in color, with one hand holding the fruit āmalaka and the other hand in the gesture of supreme giving. Hayagrīva, and Vijayī of the Three Worlds — the one who strives to subdue the hostile — these two are to be painted in attendance upon their respective deities. In the center between those two, Locanā, Māmakī, Pāṇḍarāvāsinī, and Tārā are each to be painted bearing their own attributes in their hands. Below them, a lotus pond is to be painted, complete with water, makaras, fish, tortoises, white frogs, carp and the like, and filled entirely with the many varieties of water-born flowers. Incense, lamps, fragrance, garlands, food offerings, flowers, and various kinds of fruit are to be painted. Below that, the practitioner is to be painted with palms joined, paying homage, seated.

Then this painted image is to be venerated with full honor. One is oneself to perform the eye-opening ceremony, and one is to visualize it as consecrated by truth.

Then, if one sees a sign, one will swiftly attain the attainment. But if one does not see one, the attainment will come after a long time.

If one hears laughter, the sound of drums,
the sound of bells, the sound of thunder,
and sees monks, brahmins, men and women,
and fruits — then swiftly
the supreme, middling, and lesser attainments will be accomplished.

Then that image, having been consecrated with the secret mantra and the mudrā, is to be worshipped with whatever one possesses. Even while remaining constantly in direct presence —

Having been victorious over the three worlds,
after performing self-protection and the like,
meditating on one's own suchness,
until the signs of attainment arise,
one recites three hundred thousand or six hundred thousand times.

Then, in a solitary place,
one is to complete a full eight hundred recitations.
The mantra is to be recited without error or confusion.

Then, at the close of that recitation,
one visualizes the maṇḍala as before,
performs extensive offerings,
and recites continuously, session after session, without break.

If one then beholds the principal deity, or that deity's offspring,
or any of the gods,
one should request from that vessel of merit
the supreme attainment, as one desires.

The deity, ever delighting in that being,
will bestow the fruit of the attainment.

One pays homage and receives the attainment and the rest.
One then offers a share to the Three Jewels and to one's teacher,
and thereafter uses the remainder oneself always.

If the attainment is not present, a wise person
should take it up and make use of it personally.

One will then remain for many eons,
striving to benefit all sentient beings.
But even if the supreme attainment is not obtained,
all activities will become fully efficacious.
Yakṣas, shooting stars, possessing spirits, and the like —
cut off by punishment and subdued by mere command —
all activities of pacification and the rest
will be accomplished as if by a servant.

Then Śakra (Indra), lord of the gods, addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, how may those sentient beings who, through having committed evil deeds, have come under the power of hell and the other lower states of existence, be delivered from the suffering of those states?

The Blessed One declared: O lord of the gods, listen well. Hear now how those sentient beings who commit evil deeds, who commit great evil deeds, and who thereby come under the power of hell and the other lower states, may be easily liberated from the sufferings of hell.

Just as a maṇḍala is drawn and then,
as before, one recites into a vase
one hundred and eight times,
one is to perform the empowerment most carefully.
Through this, all evil is thoroughly purified,
and one is swiftly liberated
from the suffering of hell and the other lower states.
That very being, freed from evil and purified,
is born into the family of the pure gods,
and thereafter will always hear
the Buddha and the Dharma proclaimed.

Whether one draws an image of that deity
or writes even the name in saffron —
in order to liberate sentient beings
from the suffering of the three lower realms,
a compassionate one skilled in mantra
bestows the empowerment as a benefit to others.
Then a yogin
confers the empowerment with mantra and mudrā.

Having been contemplated in the form of the deity,
it is to be placed at the center of a stūpa.

One writes the essence mantra of one's own deity
or of another deity upon the chest,
arouses the mind in likeness to that deity,
and places it within a home.

Having proclaimed that deity's name,
one writes the mantra in fine saffron.

Then gradually, until one hundred thousand recitations are complete,
one performs the rite from the stūpa.

In order to exhaust the evil of an evildoer,
one completes ten million recitations.

If this is done in this way, without fail
that being will be liberated from hell.

Freed from the suffering of hungry ghosts and animals,
one is born in a divine abode.

Calling upon that deity by name
and reciting the mantra as taught —
whether completing a thousand hundred-thousand recitations,
or a thousand hundred-thousands,
or reciting up to ten million times —
one will certainly be born in a divine abode.

Calling again upon that deity's name,
if a skilled practitioner performs the fire offering
for one hundred hundred-thousands
or for a thousand hundreds,
one is liberated from the evil
that had consigned one to the great hell.

For as long as one is born
in a place of blazing signs of existence —
until the true signs arise —

With sesame, white mustard, rice and other grains,
together with goat's milk,
and firewood anointed with fragrant substances,
one performs the fire offering according to the rite.

Thereafter, one will certainly be born again
in a divine abode,
and the signs of that will be revealed.
Or one may become supreme among the gods.

Or within the fire-offering pit
the fire will display auspicious signs,
and the signs of being born in a divine abode
and of evil being vanquished are these:
the flame burns white and to the right,
it burns upward, it is stainless,
it is round, it does not scatter,
it is steady, lightning-bright, and without impurity.

Or the fire deity himself
will manifest in that very form —
white as a stainless moon,
with a bright white complexion, blazing steadily.

By these signs, one should understand
that one has been liberated from hell and the like,
that evil has been overcome,
and that one has been born in a fortunate realm.

One digs a pit according to the rite,
measuring four cubits in depth,
and in its center one draws
a wheel encircled by a vajra border.
The mudrās of the five families
one draws in their respective directions.
Likewise one draws the bodhisattvas
and the Lords of the World and the rest.

Birds and full vases,
vessels filled with tormā offerings —
these are arranged in a set of eight,
or alternatively in a set of sixteen.
Food offerings and ritual cakes,
garlands of flowers and the like in the same way,
banners of silk, victory standards and streamers,
and the finest parasols — all finely arranged.

In the sacred maṇḍala of the fire offering
one performs the fire offering supremely.
Having drawn it according to the rite and with knowledge of the ceremony,
one invites the many gods,
and knowing the mantras and the mudrās of the mantras,
one presents the arghya water offering,
then, in brief, having made the offerings,
one performs the consecration with the divine engagement.

With camphor, saffron and the like,
ghee and milk and sesame,
sesame and white mustard, rice and other grains,
one fills the vessel excellently with fragrant water.
Rice, hare, musk deer,
honey, meat, sugar —
one recites the mantra over these many hundreds of times,
and likewise over the firewood;
the wood consecrated with one's own mantra
is to be placed inside the pit.
The offering substance, having been consecrated with the mantra,
is then washed with the finest water
and anointed with the fragrance of the recitation.
Covered with cloth and ornaments,
one fumigates with incense consecrated by mantra,
and makes offerings with flower garlands and the like.
Upon the topknot and the two shoulders, likewise,
one places written mantras.
At the heart, the hidden place, and facing the mouth,
one consecrates with Sarvavid.
At the forehead, the ūrṇā hair, the two ears,
the crown of the head, the topknot, the two shoulders,
the nose, the waist, the knees,
the tip of the finger, the tip of the nose,
the two eyes, and the abode
of the faculties of the secret place —
upon each of these places one affixes the written mantra syllables.
This is the supreme arrangement of virtue.

Then, for the purification of the lower realms,
it is to be placed, together with its seat,
directly in the center of the hearth.

Then the mantra-holder covers the offering
with a cloth consecrated by mantra.

Next, one kindles the virtue of the bali offering —
the body blazing with a mass of a thousand tongues of flame,
the body peaceful as the white moon and the kunda flower,
with a form of limitless body, one draws in the fire,
and having contemplated the arghya offering accordingly,
one places form and other offerings before the supreme Wisdom.
Desiring the qualities as they have been taught,
one invites the assembly of Tathāgatas accordingly,
and presenting the arghya and the rest accordingly,
one performs the offerings and the rest as the Sugata has taught.

Then one should examine the bali offering.

Having been burned and filled, it is set ablaze again.

Then, having been burned and filled, in sequence
one examines it at a hundred and eight for the Victor and the rest.

Then, to the king of purifying mantras —

One should examine twenty-one things to be burned. Then, having invited the assembly and presented the ritual implements three times, one makes offerings to the white-faced Lotus — the arghya and the rest. Vajrapāṇi, bearing a lotus lasso, his form victorious over the three worlds, presses down upon wrong with the lotus of his feet, and all his ornaments are fully perfect, the crown of a fully awakened buddha rising high — one should visualize this, or alternatively draw it.

By the heart-mantra of that one, likewise, one should perform the fire offering one hundred thousand times, one thousand times, or indeed up to ten million times. If signs such as marks appear, this is called the continuum of the sinful one. Then, when it has been reduced to ash, one should gather it with the mantra of the vajra-gathering, according to the ritual procedure.

That ash and the dust of bone, infused water prepared with mantras, lotus water, milk, and the rest — five substances — the wise one should sprinkle these with one hundred thousand recitations of the purifying mantra. Then, having blended them with camphor fragrance and ointment, one may form

them into a figure, or alternatively fashion them in the manner of a stūpa — one, two, three, or five, or up to one hundred and eight. Having sealed them with mantra and mudrā, one should recite up to two hundred thousand times.

Then, if the stūpa blazes, or the face of the image smiles, if fragrance, incense, or light appear, if radiance or emanation arises, if forms of gods and other beings appear in diverse aspects, if miraculous transformations and displays occur, if flowers and such are scattered, if the sounds of conch shells, drums, flutes, lutes, and the like are heard — if the sinful one does not see these signs in the mind, then, having made offerings to the Tathāgata, one should recite in meditative equipoise — eight hundred thousand, or however many recitations are needed until the signs arise. And at the end, the expert should recite without sleeping for even a single moment marked by a sign.

Then one will clearly see that person's negativity has been purified. One will see that the body has taken on a divine form, and one will come to recognize this within one's own continuum. Having known these signs, even with a non-conceptual mind, possessed of loving-kindness and compassion, one will perform all activities.

If, however, these are not present, then through the manner of reciting and meditating, one should write out even just the name clearly, and make a garland of stūpas, or alternatively draw an image. If one then performs a fire offering empowerment, one will without fail take rebirth in a higher realm. The ash, along with mustard seeds, sand, and such things, should have one's own name spoken and mantras applied to them; then, having performed recitations, one should go and cast them into a river flowing into the ocean.

Even one who is sinful, if by such means they are freed from the lower realms — then how much more for one who generates the highest virtue, who holds the seed of awakening, who possesses the causes for the fruit of buddhahood, who is endowed with the perfection of generosity, who is fully possessed of the continuum of moral discipline, who has cultivated the causes through patience, diligence, meditative equipoise, and wisdom — how much more is the merit of such a worldly being! Their lower realms will swiftly be destroyed — of this there is no doubt.

But for one who has not generated roots of virtue, who holds the view of their non-existence, who has turned away from the path of awakening, who acts with aversion toward the teaching and causes harm to it, who sees their own sinful nature, who has abandoned mother and father, who has relied upon the

awakening mind and then killed those free from attachment — or if the gods are absent, and likewise the Buddha, the Saṅgha, the Dharma, the hosts of mantras and mudrās, wisdom, and skillful means are absent — then those sinful ones will not be freed. This is what the Sugata, the Victor himself, declared.

Then the gods, beginning with Indra (Śakra), opened their eyes like lotuses, expressed their delight with the word "Excellent!", and having made offerings with great gladness, Indra, exerting himself for the benefit of others —

In accordance with the declaration that was spoken, the Lord of the Śākyas declared it to be the very truth. Then, having been freed from the suffering of the hells, all sentient beings were born in the Joyful Heaven (Tuṣita) for the benefit of others, born in the likeness of the Sugata.

Then the greatly renowned gods, together with Indra, performed dances, and with boundless clouds of offerings they assembled the hosts of gods before them in order to make offering to the Tathāgata. In order to make offering in this very life, they also aroused the awakening mind. They filled the Grove of Joy with divine substances of every variety — flowers, incense, and ointments; parasols, victory banners and standards; ornaments of every beautiful kind; precious garments like a rainfall of jewels — and made it entirely full. Then, struck with great wonder, the gods too bowed in prostration, and they asked: "What is the origin of all this variety that has appeared, filling the charming Grove of Joy on every side?"

The Blessed One declared: "Friends, know this: this miraculous display of transformation is the son of the gods named Vimalaraśmi Ratna — Jewel of Stainless Radiance. That one who had fallen under the power of the uninterrupted hells (ānarṭhya, the most extreme) and yet has come under the power of a fortunate destiny in this very present experience — that is wondrous, O Blessed One! Wondrous is the Sugata!"

Then all the sons of the gods together with Indra spoke in unison these words:

There is no teacher comparable to the Buddha.

There is no virtue comparable to the Dharma.

There is no vessel comparable to the Saṅgha.

There is no guide comparable to mantra.

Then those sons of the gods addressed the Blessed One thus: "O Blessed One, what manner of being is this son of the gods born into the divine class of the

Joyful Heaven through the blessing of the Blessed One? What is the nature of his miraculous power and might? We wish to behold this son of the gods called Jewel of Stainless Radiance."

Then the Blessed One emitted from both great toes of his feet a garland of light-rays named "Rouser of the Hearts of All Gods." That garland illuminated the entire body of the one called Jewel of Stainless Radiance, entered his heart and roused him, and then disappeared in that very place.

Thereupon that son of the gods was filled with supreme joy, and with the light-rays of his body he illuminated the entire face of the sky for the measure of a thousand leagues. That son of the gods, encircled by a retinue of many thousands, with them assembled before him, came by great divine miraculous power without being visible, and illuminated and made radiant the whole of the Grove of Joy. He outshone with his own radiance all the gods except the Blessed One and Indra.

Then that son of the gods prostrated at the feet of the Blessed One and uttered this solemn declaration:

How wondrous is the buddha-activity
of the Protector of the Śākya!
For thereby sentient beings fallen
into the lower realms are swiftly freed,
like a flash of lightning.

Then at that very instant there appeared before the Blessed One: drums the size of a chariot-wheel, all fashioned of precious substances, sending forth a cloud of fragrance a thousand leagues in extent; melodious sounds of divine song; wondrous displays of many marvels; and charming sounds of divine music — song, dance, percussion, flutes, drums, and cymbals. Seeing this, the assembly was seized with great wonder and spoke these words:

The qualities of the Tathāgata are inconceivable.
The many qualities of mantra are inconceivable.
Those who are the support of awakening are also inconceivable.
The pure discipline of the holy life arises beyond thought.

Then those divine sons, wishing to see more, again addressed the Blessed One: "We wish to see that divine son and the maṇḍalas of his retinue. We wish to see the Blessed One. We wish to see the Sugata."

Then the Blessed One sent forth rays of light from both his thumbs, and those immaculate rays of light illumined that divine son and all his divine retinue, stirring them into wakefulness, and then became invisible in that very place.

After that, the divine sons of the pure abodes — beginning with the one known as Vimalaprabharatna, "Immaculate Jewel-Light" — set all the groves of joy in motion, with the exception of the seats of the Blessed One and of Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), circumambulating many hundreds of thousands of times. Having circumambulated, they again and again spoke these words:

How wondrous! How great is the blessing of mantra
of all the buddhas!

For a sentient being who had committed a crime
of immediate retribution
was swiftly reborn in a divine realm.

Then those divine sons — beginning with the divine son known as Vimalaprabharatna — offered to the Blessed One jewels, gold, silver, necklaces, pearl garlands, bracelets, armlets, earrings, and many diverse and excellent adornments of various kinds; parasols, victory banners, pennants, tinkling bells, yak-tail fans, and many diverse and excellent implements of various kinds; lion thrones, bedding, palaces, immeasurable mansions, multi-storied pavilions, and many diverse and excellent dwellings of various kinds; flowers, incense, and many diverse and excellent offerings of various kinds. They also offered their own bodies, speech, and minds. And they offered many diverse and excellent mounts — cattle, horses, lions, tigers, monkeys, leopards, bears, buffalo, donkeys, deer, makaras (mythical water-beasts), pigs, goats, oxen, cows, and various desirable riding animals of many kinds. They then reverently honored the maṇḍalas of the retinue of the Blessed One, and reverently honored the maṇḍalas of the retinue of Śakra, lord of the gods. Saying "Excellent!" they honored the Blessed One and Śakra as their supreme teachers and objects of veneration, prostrated, and departed accordingly.

Then Śakra, Brahmā, and the other gods were utterly seized with wonder, and again and again praised and honored the Blessed One with the words "Excellent!", prostrated, and spoke thus: "Blessed One, for the sake of inspiring the ordinary persons of the future to hold and recite it, please teach the virtues of the recitation of the names of the Tathāgata."

"Divine sons of Śakra, Brahmā, and their company, I shall explain. Listen well and hold it in mind. Divine sons, these teachings will reach the ears of sentient

beings who are endowed with the ten virtues, but not those of base sentient beings. They will reach the ears of sentient beings who are devoted to the ten perfections, but not those of common, base sentient beings. They will reach the ears of sentient beings whose aspirations are certain, and of sentient beings who ardently desire the many qualities of non-regression. In brief, they will reach the ears of sentient beings who rely upon omniscient wisdom."

Then Śakra, Brahmā, and the other divine sons gave rise to genuine joy and spoke thus: "Blessed One, we have become vessels for this. Sugata, we have become vessels for this."

"It is for this reason that we have heard, from the very lips of the Blessed One with the lotus-face, the recitation of the name of the Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and fully awakened buddha called the Glorious King Who Completely Purifies All Miserable Destinies — and having heard it, we shall not be afraid of miserable destinies, we shall not be afraid of untimely death, we shall not be afraid of death, of downfalls, of dispersion, of destruction, and the like. Blessed One, we have without any doubt become vessels destined to attain buddhahood itself."

"Blessed One, those noble beings who perform this kind of examinations for the benefit of sentient beings — what will their fruit be? What will their karmic maturation be?"

The Blessed One declared: "Śakra, they should be regarded not merely as noble beings but as perfectly and fully awakened buddhas themselves. Śakra, it is because they utterly remove the various sufferings of sentient beings born in the great hells of uninterrupted torment and the like, who have passed to the other world; because they firmly establish them in an unwavering course toward awakening without any doubt; and because they place them on the bodhisattva grounds from which there is no regression — just as you, Śakra, once performed the benefit of the divine son called Stainless Light of the Jewel in the great hell of uninterrupted torment. Śakra, in the same way, do you think those sentient beings who perform the benefit of future sentient beings are ordinary persons?"

They replied: "Blessed One, no. Sugata, no."

"Śakra, those sentient beings are great noble beings, benefactors of others — worthy of veneration, offerings, respect, honor, and salutation even by the Tathāgatas. What need is there even to speak of the world with its gods?"

Then Śakra, Brahmā, and the other divine sons, the Four Great Kings, the ten direction-guardians, twenty-eight yakṣa commanders, the great yakṣa Precious Excellence and great Precious Excellence and others who are fully established on the bodhisattva grounds, the nāga kings Nandā and Upanandā with their retinues, together with Haritī surrounded by her five hundred children, the great yakṣa commander Pañcika and great Pañcika and others, and all the other vast and mighty gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, asuras, garuḍas, gandharvas, kinnaras, great serpents, bhūtas, pretas, piśācas, epidemic-spirits, malevolent spirits, poisons, stars, and all the rest — all of them spoke with one voice:

"Blessed One, our entire assembled gathering will take up the two feet of that great noble being upon our heads. In brief, always and continuously, at all times, we will protect, guard, and shelter him."

"Blessed One, wherever a son or daughter of good family receives this king of examinations with faith, or reads it, or extensively and correctly explains it to others, or makes offerings with parasols, victory banners, pennants, and the like, or wherever anyone — be they of the warrior caste, the brahmin caste, the merchant caste, or the common caste, or again a king, a prince, a princess, a queen, a male member of the royal retinue, a female member of the royal retinue, or anyone else — holds and reads it,

and extensively and correctly explains it to others — Blessed One, all of us assembled together here become servants of that person. We will thoroughly protect the people of his own household, the people of his kinsmen, and the people of his community, as well as his villages, towns, cities, districts, and the precincts of his royal palace. In due season we will cause rain to fall. We will cause grain and the like to grow. We will work for the welfare and happiness of the many. We will crush the many plots of foreign adversaries. Whatever malevolent sentient beings, harmful and violent, conceive thoughts inimical to that person — we will work to lay them to ruin. We will act against them. We will do to them the work of māras. We will draw near to those who cause harm. In brief, Blessed One, this king of examinations will stand for future sentient beings as the very activity of the buddhas. Therefore, Blessed One, we will protect it as we would a child."

"Śakra (Indra, lord of the gods), what you have said is so. This king of examinations should indeed be viewed in just that way. Excellent, Śakra! Strive long and diligently for the welfare and happiness of those sentient

beings dwelling in Jambudvīpa who practice evil Dharmas constantly, who have come under the power of the hells, who have sunk into the foul pit of saṃsāra."

This concludes the first examination from the king of examinations known as the Resplendent King That Thoroughly Purifies All Lower Realms.

The Second Fascicle.

Thereupon, by the power of the Blessed One, the Blessed One's bodhisattva, the great being Vajrapāṇi, set forth this subsequent examination — this king of examinations.

The hero rose from his seat,
rejoiced, and brandished the vajra,
gladdening the lord of the Śākyas.
Then, having paid homage to the chief of sages,

he entered into meditative absorption called the Vajra That Completely Purifies All Obscurations, and from the very heart of this dhāraṇī — called That Which Completely Purifies All Lower Realms — he drew forth the following:

Oṃ sarva-pāpaṃ dahana vajra hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ sarva-avāya-viśodhana vajra hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ sarva-karma-āvaraṇāni bhasmiṃ kuru hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ brum bhrūṃ vināśaya āvaraṇāni hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ brum viśodhaya āvaraṇāni hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ jvala jvalaṅgha kaṅgha kaha hana hana sarva āvaraṇāni hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ srum sara sara prasara prasara sarva āvaraṇāni hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ hūṃ hara hara sarva āparaṇāni hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ hūṃ phaṭ sarva āvaraṇāni visphōṭaya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ bṛta bṛta sarva āvaraṇāni phaṭ. Oṃ traṭa traṭa sarva āvaraṇāni hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ chinda chinda sarva āvaraṇāni hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ daha daha sarva naraka-gati-hetuṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ paca paca sarva preta-gata-hituṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ matha matha sarva tiryak-gati-hetuṃ hūṃ phaṭ.

Then the ritual accessories for these are set forth.

Oṃ sarva-apāya-viśodhani. Dhama dhama dhūpaya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ sarva-durgati-viśodhani puṣpa-vilokini hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ sarva-apāya-viśodhani jñāna-āloka-kari hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ sarva-apāya-gati-gandha-nāśani gandha-vati hūṃ phaṭ.

Then the mantras for the guardians:

Oṃ	sarva-naraka-gati-ākaraṇi	hūṃ	jaḥ	phaṭ.	Oṃ
sarva-naraka-gati-abhyuddharaṇi	hūṃ	hūṃ	phaṭ.	Oṃ	

sarva-avāya-bandhana-vimocani hūṃ baṃ phaṭ. Oṃ
sarva-apāya-gati-gahana-vināśani hūṃ hoḥ phaṭ.

Then the maṇḍala is described:

A maṇḍala in the likeness of a wheel,
adorned with eight exceedingly beautiful spokes,
complete with hub and with the rims that bear the spokes —

having drawn the inner sequence, in the hub one should place Śākyamuni, the lord of the Śākyas, the Sage. In front of him, draw the great and mighty Vajrapāṇi, the hero. Behind him, draw the Wheel-Turner. To the right direction, draw the Victor's Uṣṇīṣa; to the left, draw Vijaya. In the direction of fire, draw the mass of splendor; in the direction of Indra, the White Parasol; in the direction of wind, Vikīrṇa; in the southwest direction, draw Vijaya. Having drawn the inner portion, then draw the exterior: a square with four gateways, adorned with lion-thrones and stairways. The heroes are to be placed with hooks, nooses, chains, and pleasing bells. In all the corner directions, incense and the like are to be drawn.

Then, having anointed one's own body with fragrant perfumes and the like, one who holds the vajra enters and invokes all the deities with this mantra: Oṃ jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ. Bhagavan, ehyehi, mahākāruṇika, dṛśya hoḥ, samayastvaṃ. Then, having cultivated the resolve for the deities to depart, and having made offerings, one introduces them accordingly and confers empowerment. Through this, one is fully liberated from all lower realms, and one will be reborn in higher realms and heavenly worlds, ascending from ground to ground ever higher. All spiritual attainments will be accomplished, and without any doubt, buddhahood itself will be accomplished. As before, all activities will be performed, and one will become unobstructed in all things. Through the performance of the rites, one will be freed from all epidemic diseases, harmful spirits, poisons, and the like. Through Vajrapāṇi's hūṃ, all activities will be accomplished. All the ritual procedures of other tantras will also be accomplished.

For gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, and the like who have fallen under the sway of the lineage of the lower realms, one writes their corpse, or their image, or their name, and so forth, and through recitation, fire offerings, and empowerments, just as before, one fully liberates them from all lower realms.

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi, gazing upon the face of the Blessed One with a lion's gaze, paid homage and spoke these words: Blessed One, I request that

you explain the defining characteristics of the supreme mudrās. May all the Victors, whose minds are moved by compassion, grant their blessing.

In meditative equipoise, pressing the palms together at the forehead — this is declared by the buddhas and Sugatas as the mudrā of homage, the hand gesture of salutation.

By the knower of yoga, pressing the cupped palms together at the throat — this is declared to be always the lotus-family mudrā, the mudrā of Padma.

Pressing the vajra palms together and touching the tips of the middle fingers to the heart — this is the mudrā of the vajra family, the holder of all pledges.

Placing the left palm upturned in one's lap, and placing the right on top of it, with the two thumbs touching one another, gazing with a peaceful gaze — this is the mudrā of meditative absorption (samādhi) of the Tathāgata family, and it is declared to be the pledge-mudrā.

Reversing that same position, crossing back to front, and interlacing the thumbs and little fingers in the manner of a chain, placing it at the heart — this is the pledge-mudrā of the vajra family.

From the perfectly joined palms, bringing both thumbs and little fingers together and extending the remaining fingers — this is the pledge-mudrā of the lotus family.

From the vajra fist, bringing both middle fingers together level like a vajra, and extending the thumbs and little fingers — this is the mudrā of Vajrapāṇi.

From that same position, with the thumbs and little fingers held as they are, and bending the two index fingers and ring fingers so they resemble a lotus — this is the mudrā that purifies all lower realms, the all-purifying mudrā of the king.

From that same position, making the index fingers and little fingers resemble a jewel — this is the mudrā of empowerment.

Closing the little fingers and thumbs separately against each other, and extending the remaining fingers — this is the mudrā that burns all wickedness.

Performing the same with the left hand, transforming it accordingly — this is the mudrā of all the gods.

Taking a handful and scattering it upward — this is the mudrā of incense.

From that same position, scattering upward from below — this is the mudrā of flowers.

From that same position, raising both thumbs upward and holding them forward — this is the mudrā of lamps.

From that same position, making it resemble a conch — this is the mudrā of perfume.

From that same position, extending fully and holding — this is the mudrā of torma offerings.

From that same position, inserting both middle fingers inward — this is the mudrā of ablution water (arghya).

From the vajra-bound position, leveling both middle fingers, bending at the first joint, and extending all the fingers — this is the mudrā of dispersal.

From that same position, bending both thumbs and little fingers — this is the mudrā of total destruction.

From that same position, making it resemble blazing rays of light — this is the mudrā of the aggregate of splendor.

From that same position, circling it above the crown of the head — this is the mudrā of the white parasol.

From both vajra fists, interlacing both index fingers and both little fingers, knotting them and rotating upward — this is the mudrā of the wheel-turning sovereign.

From the vajra-clasped position, making both middle fingers into a vajra and both index fingers into the likeness of a jewel, and spreading the remaining fingers to resemble rays of light — this is the mudrā of the Victor's uṣṇīṣa.

Likewise, making both index fingers into a vajra, and clasping the remaining fingers so they resemble a vajra — this is the mudrā of complete victory.

The right hand formed into the gesture of supreme giving, and the left hand granting fearlessness — this is the mudrā of the Tathāgata.

From the vajra-clasped position, extending both index fingers and making them resemble a vajra — this is the vajra mudrā.

From that same position, bending the right index finger — this is the mudrā of the hook.

From that same position, making it resemble a flower — this is the mudrā of the arrow.

From that same position, bending it back again, with the tips of both thumbs touching — this is the mudrā of excellent intelligence.

From that same position, bending at the middle joint — this is the mudrā of the jewel.

From that same position, spreading the fingers to resemble rays of light — this is the mudrā of splendor.

From that same position, placed at the crown of the head — this is the mudrā of glory.

From that same position, held forward — this is the mudrā of laughter.

From that same position, making it resemble a lotus — this is the mudrā of the lotus.

From that same suchness, bending the two tips — this is the mudrā of the sword.

From that same position, making it resemble a bracelet — this is the mudrā of the wheel.

From that same position, making it resemble the petal of a lotus — this is the mudrā of the tongue.

From that same position, raising the tips slightly — this is the mudrā of the trident.

From that same position, raising them fully — this is the mudrā of protection.

From that same position, bending the two tips back — this is the mudrā of the yakṣa.

Bending them firmly — this is the mudrā of binding.

That same binding held forward — this is the mudrā of incense.

That same raised upward — this is the mudrā of the garland.

Held forward with both thumbs closed and rotated — this is the mudrā of the lamp.

That same made as if applying an ointment — this is the mudrā of perfume.

From that same position, bending both index fingers — this is the mudrā of the hook.

From that same position, bringing the two tips together — this is the mudrā of the lasso.

From that same position, knotting one into the other — this is the mudrā of the iron chain.

From that same position, moving it — this is the mudrā of pleasing.

The ritual of the image is likewise to be performed here accordingly. In brief, one draws an image of the Blessed One as the Victor over the three worlds. Alternatively, one draws the image in the form of a maṇḍala and venerates it with flowers and other offerings,

and having previously performed recitation of the mantra before it about a hundred thousand times, one then performs all the rites.

Then the assembly of gods — Brahmā and the rest — addressed the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi with these words: "Blessed One, through what karmic maturation did the divine son called Stainless Jewel-Light fall under the power of the sufferings of hell and the rest?"

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi, blessed by the Blessed One Śākyamuni, spoke thus: "Hear me, O Lord of Gods (Śakra, king of the gods). This is an obscuration arising from former karma. In this very continent of Jambudvīpa, in a border region, there was a king of bad family called Unwell Body. Through ignorance, he relied upon an unwholesome spiritual companion, and for the sake of desire that king came to be separated from his father, who supported him; and his mother, tormented by grief for him, also died before her time. On one occasion, for the sake of play and pleasure, he went to another dense forest. There dwelt a sage named Maitrī who sought nothing in return. When the king saw him, he was greatly astonished and thought to himself: 'Here, where lions and tigers and deer and wild boars and cattle and buffalo and the like, and snakes and scorpions and insects and mosquitoes and venomous serpents, afflict and devour one another; where one is cut off from food and drink and clothing and comforts; where one is utterly tormented and harmed by wind and cold — in this place this great being dwells.' So thinking and reflecting, he approached him and, having come before him, said: 'O great sage, why do you harm me with the sufferings of wind, heat, and the rest?'

The sage replied: 'O great man, rather than experiencing the suffering of obscurations for many hundreds and thousands of aeons, one who takes up even a small measure of suffering's burden will come to full and perfect awakening in unsurpassed, perfect enlightenment (bodhi). Therefore this is not suffering. If instead one enjoys the pleasures of the senses even for a moment, for an instant, one will thereafter experience the sufferings of hell and the rest for countless hundreds and thousands of aeons without end. When one desires sensory pleasure, one will even kill one's own parents — to say nothing of other living beings — and because one utterly fails to know the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, one will commit every kind of evil deed.'

Upon hearing those words of the sage, the king was seized with great fear and dread and dismay, overwhelmed by all these sufferings, and said: 'What are the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha? What is their nature? O great ascetic, tell me — and in them I too shall take refuge. If one harms one's parents and takes the lives of living beings, what kind of evil does one incur? If one fully comes to know the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, what merit does one thereby fully obtain? If one has not killed one's parents and has not killed living beings, what merit does one obtain? What result does one obtain? If one abandons the enjoyments of desire, what merit and what result does one obtain?'

Then that sage spoke to him in verse:

O great being, if you wish to hear these words of mine,
join your palms in veneration, bow down,
listen with reverence — and I shall explain.

Having confirmed he would do so, and having made offerings of whatever he possessed, he then came to hear the profound Dharma of the buddhas — the domain of the buddhas, the domain of the buddhas. The Buddha, the Dharma, and the pure Saṅgha —

Having heard this, they went for refuge. The king, having heard the unobscured Dharma of the buddhas, became joyful.

Hungry ghosts, animals, and hell-beings
are the fruit of every evil deed.
Those who slaughter living creatures
and the manifold unbearable sufferings,
who harm their own parents —

from such causes these arise.
For many aeons they suffer greatly;
the torments of hell are unendurable,
without protector, without refuge.

Having heard this, pierced by grief and sorrow, and afflicted in his own mind,
just as a flame is extinguished by the wind, he passed away at that very
moment.

Through the ripening of his karma, he was reborn as a god endowed with joy,
taking birth with a form like that of a minister of Śakra (Indra), the lord of gods
— in complete harmony with all the gods, born into supreme joy and
happiness. Having experienced the highest bliss, he then fell into the lower
realms.

Now, at this present time, O lord of gods, through that same power, you have
been born in Tuṣṭita, the realm of delight, the supreme abode of joy, the
dwelling of abundant happiness. Hear this, O lord of gods:

You should not think that the sage who lived and arose in that former time was
anyone other than yourself. He was none other than the Blessed One,
Śākyamuni, the Tathāgata, the arhat, the perfectly and fully awakened buddha
himself. And you should not regard the one who became his companion as
anyone other. O lord of gods, at that time, in that moment, you were that
companion. And the mother — do not regard her as anyone else: at that time,
in that moment, she was Śacikā herself. And the retinue assembled around
him — do not regard them as others: they were these very gods of your own
retinue.

Then Śakra together with Brahmā and other sons of the gods were utterly
delighted and overjoyed; the hairs of their bodies stood on end, and calling out
in a great voice, "Victor! Victor!", they praised the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi with
these ten names and made supplication:

Koṭa Koṭa Kṣa. Koṭa Ba. Koṭa Koṭa. Koṭa Bśatsa. Koṭika. Kola Kṣa. Kola Ba. Kola
Kola Bśatsa. Kola Sta Thā I Ti.

Having done so, Śakra and the other foremost gods made this prayer:

O Protector, we beseech you —
Śakra and the other highest gods —
for the benefit of all sentient beings,

to spread life and freedom from illness.
O Blessed One, for the sake of those
with short lives and little merit,
for their benefit and happiness
and for the prolonging of life,
please speak. O Lord of Secrets, please speak.

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi looked upon that great assembly of gods — Śakra, Brahmā, and the rest — and pleased them by saying, "Excellent!" He then spoke:

O sons of the gods, Brahmā and the others: this is excellent, excellent! That you have aroused such genuine courage and aspiration — that is well done. Now accomplish and proclaim it.

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi entered into the meditative absorption (samādhi) called "The Vajra That Arises Pervading the Immeasurable Life of All Sentient Beings," and from within his own heart he drew forth this essence of all the Tathāgatas — called "The Immeasurable Growth of the Accumulations of Life, Merit, and Wisdom":

Oṃ puṇye puṇye mahāpuṇye aparimita āyur puṇye jñāna saṃbhāropacite
kāriṇe svāhā.

The very moment this dhāraṇī — the essence of all the Tathāgatas — was proclaimed, all lower realms were thoroughly pacified, and he directly knew that all sentient beings born as hell-beings, animals, and hungry ghosts were liberated. He caused all world-systems to blaze with light,

and caused it to blaze with light in the manner of the twelve acts of a buddha, and then entered into those very Dharma-syllables of the mind of all the Tathāgatas.

Then once more the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called "The Vajra that Shines with Immeasurable Life," and from that absorption he proclaimed this dhāraṇī — the essence of all the Tathāgatas — called "Immeasurable Life":

Oṃ amite amita udbhave amita sambhave amita vikrānte amita vikrānta
gāmini sarva karma kleśa kṣayaṃ kare svāhā.

The very moment this was proclaimed, the suffering of all sentient beings was thoroughly pacified.

Then once more the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called "The Infallible Destroyer of Obscurations," and from his own heart he drew forth this dhāraṇī — the essence of all the Tathāgatas — called "The Severing of All Obscurations of All the Tathāgatas":

Oṃ kaṃkani kaṃkani rocani rocani troṭani troṭani trāsani trāsani pratihana pratihana sarva karma parampārāṇi me sarva satvānañca svāhā.

The very moment this was proclaimed, all things became just so.

Then once more the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called "The Vajra Free from All Stains and Completely Pure," and from his own heart he drew forth this dhāraṇī — the essence of all the Tathāgatas — called "The Complete Destruction of All Obscurations Without Remainder":

Oṃ ratne ratne mahāratne ratna sambhave ratna kiraṇe ratna māle viśuddhe śodhaya sarva pāpaṃ hūṃ trāṭ.

The very moment this was proclaimed, all the abodes of māra were conquered and utterly overthrown.

Then once more the Blessed One entered into the meditative absorption called "The Infallible Complete Destroyer of All Invincible Obscurations," and from his own heart he drew forth this dhāraṇī — the essence of all the Tathāgatas:

Oṃ amogha apratihata sarva āvaraṇa vināśani hara hara hūṃ phaṭ.

The very moment this mantra was proclaimed, all world-systems shook, shook greatly, and shook most greatly; they stirred, stirred greatly, and stirred most greatly; they were roused, roused greatly, and roused most greatly, and many wondrous marvels appeared in the world.

Then the maṇḍala is as follows:

Four-sided, with four gates,
furnished with gateways,
to be provided with four archways,
with a nave and with doorframes.

In its center, the sacred maṇḍala
of the wheel is to be drawn —
four-spoked, furnished
with a hub at the center.

In its very center, the chief figure:
Vajrapāṇi of great power,
bearing vajra and bell,
is to be drawn with the smiling face of a full moon.

Upon the eastern spoke
the protector Akṣobhya is to be drawn.
In the southern direction, the Jewel.
In the western direction, the water-born Lotus.
In the northern direction, the Infallible,
the hero of great power, is to be drawn.

All the Tathāgatas are to be drawn
arrayed in wheel-turning regalia,
their complexion resembling a lunar disc,
adorned with every ornament,
their hands in the gestures of supreme giving and fearlessness,
seated in vajra cross-legged posture.

In each of the corner directions likewise,
incense and all other offerings are to be drawn.

In the gateways, wrathful figures —
those under the sway of wrath — are to be drawn.

Then the yogin himself enters.
He invites the mantra deities:

Jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ. Oṃ bhagavān ehy ehi samayastvaṃ.

Then, when the chief deity has arrived,
and offerings have been made in brief —

Those who dwell in fear of the Lord of Death, with his serpents,
are to be led in so as to destroy the Lord of Death.

Oṃ vajra samaya hūṃ.

Having bound them with vajra tirim tiri, lead them in holding a jewel in hand.
Or alternatively, a flower garland — that is to be cast into the maṇḍala itself.

Oṃ pratīccha vajra hūṃ.

Then the pledge of the oath is to be given:

Oṃ vajra sama sa hūṃ.

Then the covering from the face is to be removed:

Oṃ vajra hāsyā udghaṭaya hūṃ.

Then this is to be shown:

Oṃ vajra paśya hoḥ.

Then empowerment is to be conferred with this:

Oṃ vajra abhiṣiñca oṃ hūṃ.

Oṃ buddha abhiṣiñca oṃ.

Oṃ ratna abhiṣiñca trāṃ.

Oṃ padma abhiṣiñca hrīḥ.

Oṃ karma abhiṣiñca aḥ.

Then the vase empowerment is to be conferred:

Oṃ vajra kalaśa abhiṣiñca hūṃ.

Oṃ buddha kalaśa abhiṣiñca oṃ.

Oṃ ratna kalaśa abhiṣiñca trāṃ.

Oṃ padma kalaśa ya abhiṣiñca hrīḥ.

Oṃ karma kalaśa abhiṣiñca aḥ.

Then the garland empowerment is to be conferred:

Oṃ ratna mālā abhiṣiñca trāṃ trāṃ trāṃ trāṃ trāṃ.

Oṃ vajra paṭṭa avalambana abhiṣiñca trāṃ.

Oṃ buddha mudrā abhiṣiñca oṃ.

Oṃ vajra mudrā abhiṣiñca hūṃ.

Oṃ ratna mudrā abhiṣiñca trāṃ.

Oṃ padma mudrā abhiṣiñca hrīḥ.

Oṃ karma mudrā abhiṣiñca aḥ.

Oṃ vajra nāma abhiṣiñca hūṃ oṃ trāṃ hrīḥ aḥ.

Oṃ vajra karma abhiṣiñca hūṃ aḥ.

Oṃ vajra cakra abhiṣiñca hūṃ bhumḥ.

Oṃ vajra cakra adhipati stvaṃ abhiṣiñca hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ oṃ oṃ oṃ trāṃ trāṃ
trāṃ hrīḥ hrīḥ hrīḥ aḥ aḥ aḥ.

Oṃ vajra dhāraṇī abhiṣiñca hūṃ.

Oṃ tathāgata dhāraṇī abhiṣiñca oṃ.

Oṃ ratna dhāraṇī abhiṣiñca trāṃ.

Oṃ padma dhāraṇī abhiṣiñca hrīḥ.

Oṃ karma dhāraṇī abhiṣiñca aḥ.

Oṃ tathāgata guhya abhiṣiñca oṃ.

Oṃ vajra guhya abhiṣiñca hūṃ.
Oṃ ratna guhya abhiṣiñca trāṃ.
Oṃ padma guhya abhiṣiñca hrīḥ.
Oṃ karma guhya abhiṣiñca aḥ.
Oṃ prajñopāya samayoga abhiṣiñca hūṃ āḥ.

Having thus conferred the empowerment, this life-sustaining awareness mantra is to be given:

Oṃ bhruṃ vajra āyuxe hūṃ āḥ.

The sādhana for this is as follows. Draw the Blessed One Vajra Life, radiant with moonlight, seated within a moon-disc maṇḍala, adorned with every ornament, his two hands in the gestures of fearlessness and supreme giving, from which nectar drips. Below this, draw the sādhana practitioner with palms outstretched, face upturned, gazing upon the Blessed One. Offer worship with the five kinds of offering, and in that deity's presence perform one hundred thousand recitations.

Then, on the fifteenth day of the lunar month, make the great offering, place a vessel of red and yellow butter on the earth, press it down with the vajra in the left hand, and with the Blessed One fully intent, recite the mantra continuously through the night without pause.

Thereupon, if a fragrance arises — an unprecedented, extraordinary scent — accompanied by vapor, or smoke, or the arising of fire, or rays of light, or a flame of light, or the emergence of radiance, or any sign of that kind, one should then thoroughly accomplish the sādhana using that butter, or clarified butter, or sesame oil, or water, or milk, or yogurt, or beer, or blood, or fat, or brain, or flesh, or whatever is suitable. Having first performed the protection and other rites, and having purified oneself, if one drinks or eats it and the signs appear exactly as described, then for as long as the moon and sun endure one's life will be long and one will become like the vajra. The least achievement is the last to be accomplished, so in this there is no room for doubt.

Even if the signs do not appear, one will be free from illness in this world, free from blemish and harm, and the body will be free from white hair and wrinkles. The body will be firm, and one will be able to sustain life for a hundred years. Moreover, by recitation alone one will accomplish pacification, increase,

power (abhiṣeka) and the other activities need not be examined further — of this there is no doubt.

Then the four great kings bowed before the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi and spoke these words: "Blessed One, we too wish to set forth our own essence mantras for the sake of all sentient beings, for their benefit and happiness. We request that the Blessed One grant permission, and that the Vajra-Holder grant permission."

The Blessed One replied: "Great kings, speak well, and I too shall rejoice and bestow blessing upon it."

Then the yakṣa king Vaiśravaṇa, having been given leave by the Blessed One and rejoicing, and blessed, recited his own essence mantra: Oṃ vai.

Then the gandharva king Dhṛtarāṣṭra also recited his own essence mantra: Oṃ dhṛi.

Then the kumbhāṇḍa king Virūḍhaka also recited his own essence mantra: Oṃ vi.

Then the nāga king Virūpākṣa also recited his own essence mantra: Oṃ kṣa.

Then the maṇḍala of those kings was described:

Square in form, with four gateways,
adorned with five maṇḍalas:
at its center the principal figure,
Vajrapāṇi, draw him standing proud.

To his left
Vaiśravaṇa, in his virtuous hand
holding a banner and a mongoose,
adorned with precious ornaments,
corpulent, seated upon a lion throne —
draw him with golden hue and radiant splendor.

A master craftsman shall draw the fine vase
and other vessels with rivers of jewels flowing forth.

In front, Dhṛtarāṣṭra himself,
diligent in taking up the lute,
beautiful, of blue-green complexion,
adorned with all his ornaments — draw him thus.

To the right, the hero of exalted body,
draw him holding a sword in hand.

To the west, Virūpākṣa (He of Ill-Favored Eyes),
supreme holder of the vajra-lasso,
encircled by seven serpent heads,
his eyes red and blazing intensely.

At the directions of the gateways
the gatekeepers are similarly arranged.

Then, with the mudrā called the vajra-mudrā,
the mantra-master himself entering in,
invites the Blessed One,
and thereupon invites the king.

Having invited them, the master makes offerings with skill,
and presents the arghya water according to the ritual.

Then the mantra-master, with this mantra
and with the mudrā of the Vajra-Holder,
leads the disciple — whether of royal lineage, of noble lineage,
of brahmin lineage, or the like —
to enter holding flowers or precious gems:

Oṃ vajra samaya hūṃ.

Then with this flower or precious gem the disciple shall cast it:

Oṃ vajra pratīccha tvam mahottama.

Upon whatever king it falls,
by this alone shall his purpose be accomplished — there is no other way.

Then with the four vases set in the corners,
the empowerment is conferred:

first, Vajrapāṇi confers the empowerment by his mudrā.

And so on in order — when the empowerment is thus conferred within the
maṇḍala,

one who is not a king becomes a king,
and one who is already a king becomes great:
endowed with the glory of sovereignty over Jambudvīpa,
supreme ruler over all four continents.

When the empowerment has been conferred four times
and entry made four times,
the Vajra-Holder, sovereign king,
shall cherish that person as a beloved child.

We the four great kings, together with our servants and retinues,
along with the palace courts and all their assemblies,
shall always protect that king.

We shall crush the harm caused by enemies' secret agents,
the dangers of illness and the lord of death,
famine and all such afflictions.

Vaiśravaṇa shall bring increase;
Dhṛtarāṣṭra shall pacify;
Virūḍhaka, the lord of death of exalted body,
shall slay untimely death for livestock and kinspeople alike;
Virūpākṣa shall bring auspiciousness
and utterly destroy famine and the like.

In short, I shall fulfill
all the hopes and wishes of that one.
If I should fail to keep this pledge,
may I be held to account before Vajrapāṇi.

Then the world-guardians bowed before the Blessed One and spoke these words: "Blessed One, we too shall offer our respective essences for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings."

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent, excellent, world-guardians! Offer them well."

Then the lords of the elemental spirits, beginning with the powerful one, offered their respective essences: Oṃ ī. Oṃ iṃ. Oṃ a. Oṃ ya. Oṃ ri. Oṃ va. Oṃ ya. Oṃ ku. Oṃ a. Oṃ bra.

Then their maṇḍala was described, and one should draw it as the earlier maṇḍala. Place the Protector in the center, and set each world-guardian in their own direction. Before the image, place the sun and the form of a boar as a pair. The gate-guardians likewise. Then, having summoned them all, one should make offering with all forms of worship. Then, entering oneself, one should introduce the disciples, and confer empowerment upon them using the vases charged with the mantra of each world-guardian. Then, desiring benefit,

one should bestow the essences for accomplishment, and the domains of each world-guardian shall be accomplished without the need for further examination.

Then, pleased, they spoke again: "Blessed One, whoever is consecrated by empowerment at the crown as a sovereign of the royal lineage, who enters this royal maṇḍala and receives empowerment, or any other son of good family or daughter of good family who has faith — all such persons we shall guard, protect, and shelter always and at all times. We shall crush all enemies' secret agents. We shall send down rain at the proper seasons. We shall cause grains, flowers, and fruits to grow."

Then the great Dharma king Yama bowed before the Blessed One and spoke these words: "Blessed One, I too shall prolong the life of that great king. I shall individually avert each of the eight untimely deaths."

The great lord of the rākṣasas (Skt. rākṣasa), Riti, also spoke thus: "Blessed One, I too shall protect the king, the king's sons, brahmins, the warrior caste, ordinary people, and any others whatsoever, so that they have no fear of illness, hungry ghosts, or malevolent spirits. I shall ensure they have no fear from rākṣasas and the like. I shall ensure they have no fear of untimely death, and I shall guard, protect, and shelter them always and at all times."

Then the great king of the nāgas, Varuṇa, spoke thus: "Blessed One, we too shall always and at all times look after that king and each and every land, shall protect them entirely, shall cause grains to grow, shall prevent the arising of nāga-caused afflictions, shall not bring down lightning and hail, and shall individually avert untimely death."

Then the lord of the winds spoke thus: "Blessed One, I too shall ensure that no harm from wind arises at any time for that great being. I shall ensure that winds out of season do not arise. I shall cause all grains, flowers, and fruits to grow. I shall individually avert all dangers."

Then the great king of the yakṣas, Kubera, bowed before the Blessed One and spoke these words:

"Blessed One, I too shall come together with twenty-eight great yakṣa commanders and, with my power, shall individually avert all fears for that great being at all times. I shall ensure that all wealth and grain are fully provided. I shall protect his own people, the people of all lands, the district, the locality, manservants, relatives by marriage, relatives by lineage, friends,

sons, daughters, wives, and so forth. I shall also protect oxen, cattle, donkeys, female buffalo, sheep, buffalo, yaks, horses, goats, and so forth."

Then the lord of all spirits, Vaiśravaṇa (Indra of the yakṣas, the great guardian king of the north), bowed before the Blessed One and spoke these words: "Blessed One, I too shall protect that king and the sons of those kings, the warrior caste, and the brahmin caste in this life and the next; I shall benefit them, fully protect them, bring them peace and auspiciousness, avert annihilation, avert weapons, neutralize poison, destroy poison, cut off boundaries, cut off subterranean boundaries, cut off directional boundaries, surround them with a wall of stones, plant vajra-stakes, and weave nets of vajras. I shall remain present for all their needs. I shall reveal the signs of what is needed and of what is not needed. All that is virtuous and all that is non-virtuous I shall communicate even in dreams. When they undertake accomplishments there shall be no obstacle. I shall grant all attainments."

Then the lord of the garuḍas, those who move through the sky, bowed before the Blessed One and spoke these words: "Blessed One, we too shall at all times, I and all my retinue, come to that king, the sons of the king, the king's ministers, brahmins, and the warrior caste, and shall guard, protect, and shelter them from all fears. We shall bestow all excellences. We shall thoroughly pacify all illness. At all times we shall follow them like a shadow."

Then the great lord beneath the earth bowed before the Blessed One and spoke these words: "Blessed One, I too shall fulfill all aims at all times for that lord of men, for the sons of that lord of men, and for those who have taken birth a second time or the sons of those who have taken birth a second time, for the warrior caste, the lesser nobility, the common people, or, moreover, for faithful sons of good family and daughters of good family. I shall at all times protect them from all fears. I myself shall fully protect them."

Then the eight great planets together with the asterisms spoke these words: "Blessed One, we together with our retinues wish to offer our own mantra-essences. May the Blessed One consecrate them."

"Excellent! Excellent! I consecrate them. Let the great planets speak."

Then the great planets, beginning with the Sun, bowed before the Blessed One and spoke these words:

Oṃ ā. Oṃ so. Oṃ aṃ. Oṃ bu. Oṃ bṛ. Oṃ śu. Oṃ sa. Oṃ rā.

Then the maṇḍala of these beings was described. In the center, the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi himself is to be drawn in the form of the Victor Over the Three Worlds. On the four sides, the four great mudrās are to be drawn.

The lotus in full bloom is drawn to the front;
the moon is to be drawn behind.
To the right a vajra-stake is drawn,
and to the left the remaining planets are drawn.
In the direction of fire is the red-eyed one;
in the direction of wind is the Sun.
In the direction of Vaiśravaṇa is Saturn.
In the direction of the rākṣasas, Rāhu is drawn.
Along the outer border of the maṇḍala,
all the asterisms are to be drawn.

At each of the gates, the gatekeepers likewise are to be drawn in wrathful form. The master, having entered as Vajrapāṇi himself, then summons all with the vajra-hook and the rest:

oṃ vajra hana hūṃ phaṭ — oṃ vajra graha samaye hūṃ phaṭ — oṃ vajra graha pratīccha samaye hūṃ.

Then empowerment is conferred by means of the eight vases sealed with the mantras of the eight planets, and by conferring empowerment with the vajra mudrā, all the planets are to be propitiated.

Then those great planets prostrated to the Blessed One and spoke these words: "Blessed One, we eight great planets will likewise always and at all times do the same for that great king and for the king's son — constantly, at all times, in every respect."

Then the deities of the maṇḍala — those of the asterisms, the moments, the instants, the fractions of time, the hours, the lunar days, the conjunctions, the lunar mansions, the seasonal junctures, the water-clock measures, and so forth — likewise prostrated and spoke these words: "Blessed One, we too will at all times never transgress the command of those great beings, but will tend to them as a lord tends to his charge. We will individually protect every city, every town, every region, every king, every palace and its surroundings, and every royal residence and its grounds. And whenever great terrors arise, if he worships us, we will without fail prevent those terrors from occurring."

Then the eight great nāgas pleased the Blessed One with the word "phud" and spoke these words: "Blessed One, we too offer to all of them this secret essence." The great nāgas duly offered the secret essences. Then, delighted, they prostrated to the Blessed One and spoke these words:

oṃ phu — oṃ pha — oṃ phū — oṃ phā — oṃ phī — oṃ phe — oṃ phai — oṃ phau.

Then their maṇḍala was described. On the great eight-petalled lotus, it is to be drawn in white. In its center the chief deity is Vajrapāṇi, firmly established, surrounded by a boundless mass of serpent-heads, a great coiling serpent, threatening in posture — draw him thus. In the same way, Ananta and Karkoṭaka and Kulika, Vasuki, Śaṅkhaṇḍa, Padma, and Varuṇa — in short, on each individual petal, draw each of these with blazing serpent-heads. Draw them with their wives of seven serpent-heads, embracing them around the neck. The eight vases, the torma offerings, the beautiful bali cakes, the offerings to spirits, butter, milk, and honey — all these prepared items are to be placed there.

Then, having entered as the vajra-nature itself, one summons those with serpent-heads by means of the serpent-head mudrā, saying "phud," and recites hūṃ bhaṃ hoḥ. Then the prince and all the royal lineage having been fully admitted, empowerment is conferred by the word "phud" in order to dispel the harm of poison.

Then even by the mere utterance of the names, all those nāgas will accomplish everything. Then, all of them delighted, they prostrated to the Blessed One, took their places with palms joined in his presence, and offered up their aspiration:

"Blessed One, if those who delight in the teaching of the Blessed One and who have entered this maṇḍala are deceived, then may the Blessed One himself be considered deceived. At that time may our abodes be burned with sand. May our heads be split by blazing vajras on every side. We will always and at all times protect, guard, and shelter those great beings."

We will generate great blessing, power, and diligence. We will make that land free of poison. At regular times we will send down rain. Upon all the armies of enemies we will send down rain in season and out of season. We will utterly destroy all fears. We will perfectly accomplish the command of the Victor and the command of the Vajra-holder.

Then the sādhanā is explained in verse:

Visualizing Vajrapāṇi, the chief of Vajra-holders, crowned with four serpent heads and encircled by a white garland of divine light, recite the mantra called Phud one hundred thousand times.

Then, having drawn out the poison, visualize the maṇḍala of the action called Phud. Fill it with a garland of divine light-rays and visualize within it the mantra called Phud. With the hand resembling a serpent-head noose, scatter it with the wind of the mantra called Phud. All the poisons residing in skin, flesh, and bone, without remainder, are drawn out by the hand of the mantra called Phud.

Then, for accomplishing all activities, for poison-plague and compound poisons and the like — if all of these can be removed even by a fist-gesture, what need is there to mention the mudrā of the serpent head?

Then the Great Terrifier, the great wrathful lord who is master over the great gods, surrounded by eight great goddess-consorts, prostrated to the Blessed One and spoke these words:

"Blessed One, by our terrifying cry and by the terror of the goddess-consorts, all gods, nāgas, and the rest are terrified, completely terrified, utterly terrified — they fall face down, stripped of their garments, lose their minds, and reel about in all directions. For the benefit of those beings we wish to offer our essence-mantras. May the Blessed One graciously bestow his blessing upon this."

"Excellent, excellent, Great Terrifier! You who are the Supreme Terrifier — recite the essence-mantras of yourself and of all divine goddess-consorts."

Then the Great Terrifier uttered the cry of terror and spoke thus:

Oṃ bhairaṇa bhī svāhā. Oṃ bhā svāhā. Oṃ bhi svāhā. Oṃ bhū svāhā. Oṃ bhe svāhā. Oṃ bhai svāhā. Oṃ bhau svāhā. Oṃ bhaṃ svāhā. Oṃ bhaḥ svāhā.

"Blessed One, these eight Great Terrifiers listen to my words."

Then their maṇḍala is described:

Draw a great wheel with eight spokes. In its center, place Vajrapāṇi, the great wrathful one who is victorious over the three worlds — he is to be named Conqueror. At his feet, draw the Great Terrifier in an aspect of fierce great wrath, together with his terrifying consort. Within all the spokes as well, draw the other eight Terrifiers together with their goddess-consorts, with wrathful

faces and wrathful minds, in whatever arrangement is pleasing. Here too, at each gate in the same manner, draw the gatekeepers with their exceedingly wrathful aspect.

Then, drawing them in with a hook and the like, fill a skull-cup with blood and make offerings. Offer excellent flesh, beer, and torma cakes. Fill vessels with blood. Place in that maṇḍala: skull fragments, skull pieces, eight vases filled with blood or beer. Then the supreme Victor of the three worlds should introduce the disciples. Empowerment is thus conferred upon them by means of the eight vases or skull-cups.

Then the activities are to be given. In a woman's house, or for a single night, the supreme tamer of the three worlds is to be properly worshipped, and the mantra recited four hundred thousand times.

Then, upon hearing the sound of the great self-nature of the Terrifier, fearlessly fill a skull-cup with supreme blood and present it as an arghya offering.

Then the wrathful Terrifier, surrounded by a retinue of fierce-minded goddess-consorts, terrifying —

— surrounded by eight, they shall be seen. Upon seeing them, one should be without fear, recollect the syllable Hūṃ, and present a skull-cup filled with flesh or with supreme wine. Then the wrathful Terrifier, subduer of the malevolent, will be thoroughly pleased, and being pleased, will speak the words "What do you desire?" and with a gladdened mind will bestow it. With the exception of giving the grounds themselves, one should request in the manner of great bliss and Hūṃ: the drink that overflows with seminal fluid, substances, sword and wheel, the trident, and the heavenly realms; sovereignty over humans and the underworld; the continent and the four hundred island-continents; lordship over yakṣas, rākṣasas, and the like; the state of a vidyādhara, and the cakravartin of vidyādharas; lordship over the three worlds; obedient followers; one's own retinue; and whatever accomplishments pertaining to women — whatever is wished for, all of this he will bestow. Having bestowed it, he laughs and departs. If one is fearful, he will kill that person on the spot.

Then Brahmā and the other great gods, having prostrated to the Blessed One, spoke thus: "Blessed One, we too request that the Blessed One, having compassionately considered us, kindly speak our own tantras and bless us." Thereupon the Blessed One, bearing them with compassion, consented to

bless them. Then those gods, Brahmā and the rest, recited their own heart-essences: Om̐ Ā. Om̐ Bhi. Om̐ Ru. Om̐ I. Om̐ Kaṃ. Om̐ Ga. Om̐ Bri. Om̐ Ka. Then their maṇḍalas were described. Draw them as the preceding maṇḍala. In the center, draw the Tamer of the Three Worlds. Before him, draw the hero Īśvara holding the trident. Behind him, draw Brahmā. To the left, draw one holding a wheel in hand. To the right, draw Indra (Śakra) holding the emblem of his own mudrā in hand. The subordinate maṇḍalas of each deity's own kind are arranged here in the same way. Set out birds and a filled vase. Outside the maṇḍala, place Subala and other greatly powerful ones. Then, entering, the adept should summon all the gods from every direction. Jaḥ Hūṃ Baṃ Hoḥ — may all gods be seated in the sacred maṇḍala. Then, upon seeing them arrive, worship them with great joy. Then, by the mudrā of Vajrapāṇi, introduce the disciples: Om̐ prātīccha tvaṃ mahāsattva vajradhāra ājñāpaya om̐ hūṃ ha ha ha hoḥ. Cast the flower as in the flower ritual and, opening the eyes, reveal. Then confer empowerment with the water of the vase consecrated by mantra. Then bestow whatever accomplishments the gods desire.

Whether one hundred thousand or two hundred thousand recitations, having first performed the approach practice, one accomplishes the supreme among gods such as Īśvara and the rest through this sādhana. Whether at a place known as the Single Banner, or at the palace of Vajrapāṇi, or at a Tathāgata stūpa containing relics — if one always performs the sādhana of all those gods duly according to the ritual, then at midnight the deity will arise and say: "Whatever is your wish, that I will freely grant. Speak it quickly, for I will give you the supreme." Then, to obtain accomplishments, the one who knows mantra should make the supreme request to the deity: divine substances, the drink of overflowing seminal fluid, invisibility, ḍākinīs, pill-substances, sovereignty, and so forth — make requests boundlessly as the mind desires.

Then the Great God (Śiva) Maheśvara and the rest, having prostrated to the Blessed One, spoke thus: "Blessed One, those who have entered this maṇḍala — worldly and transcendent — may all the gods purify all their obscurations completely."

We will show the path to the higher realms. We will show the path free from the lower realms. We will show the path free from obscuration. We will show the path of solitude. We will show the path of complete solitude. We will show the path of arising. We will show the path to nirvāṇa. We will show the path of the sacred Dharma. We will show the path to the happy destinies. We will

show the path of renunciation. We will show the path free from affliction. We will show the path to the attainment of buddhahood. We will show the path to the attainment of bodhisattvahood. We will show the path to the attainment of Vajrapāṇi's own state. At all times, from all fears, we will guard, protect, and shelter. We will care for them as though they were our own children. We will crush all their enemies from the other side. We will protect villages, their environs, regions, kings, royal palaces, and kingdoms. We will protect countries, directions, cities, and towns. We will also grant sovereignty. Those who have already obtained sovereignty, we will cause their sovereignty to flourish. The lordship over one continent, two continents, three continents, four continents, the happy destinies, the human realm, the realm beneath the earth, and the status of a wheel-turning monarch — all of these we will bestow. In brief, we will grant even the state of Śakra himself, the state of Brahmā himself, the state of whatever one desires, and the state of the Great Lord himself.

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi surveyed the entire assembly of the maṇḍala and smiled, and those maṇḍalas of the retinue stirred, greatly stirred, thoroughly and greatly stirred; they shook, greatly shook, thoroughly and greatly shook; they blazed, greatly blazed, thoroughly and greatly blazed; they laughed, greatly laughed, thoroughly and greatly laughed; they played, greatly played, thoroughly and greatly played — and many wondrous marvels appeared perfectly and fully throughout the world.

Then the assembly of gods, led by Brahmā, becoming very still and reverent, prostrated to the Blessed One and said: "Blessed One, buddhas, the Blessed Ones, and bodhisattvas do not smile without a reason. What then is the reason for this smile? Blessed One, we pray that you prophesy to us the reason for this smile."

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi, having heard the petition of the gods, spoke thus: "O gods, led by Brahmā — have you heard of the great and glorious vidyā that was taught by all the previous buddhas, which pacifies the lord of death, and the powerful vidyā-mantra that destroys the lord of untimely death?"

Then the great gods of that assembly, led by Brahmā, prostrating to the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi, were filled with great joy, their hair standing on end, and they offered these words of "Excellent!": "Blessed One, excellent, excellent! Vajrapāṇi, excellent, excellent! For the sake of extending the life of

sentient beings with short lives; for the sake of liberating from untimely death those threatened by the lord of untimely death, so that they are freed from dying before their time; for the sake of liberating, by any and all means, those born in the lower realms from all streams of lower-realm existence; and for the sake of causing sentient beings who are frightened by the terrors of saṃsāra to turn their backs on saṃsāra with ease, and swiftly to perfectly and completely realize unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening — we pray that you teach the vidyā of great majesty and power, of great might."

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi, having heard the petition of the gods led by Brahmā —

drew forth this very essence of all Tathāgatas from the vajra of body, speech, and mind.

Oṃ puṇye puṇye mahā-puṇye aparimitāyuh-puṇye jñāna-saṃbhāropacite svāhā. This is the vidyā of the essence. Oṃ hrīḥ svāhā. This is the vidyā of the near-essence. Oṃ bhrum svāhā. This is the vidyā of the concentrated essence. Oṃ krum svāhā. This is the vidyā that perfectly summons the essence. Oṃ trāṃ svāhā. This is the supreme essence. Oṃ hrīm svāhā. This is the secret essence.

Then the maṇḍala of these deities is described. The maṇḍala is to be made with four spokes. In its center is placed the one called "the Tathāgata, King of Immeasurable Life, Merit, Wisdom, and Accumulations, and of Immeasurable Splendor," whose essence is the syllable Bhrum. Before him stands Vajrapāṇi, whose essence is the syllable Hrīḥ. To his left stands the wrathful one, whose essence is the syllable Krum. To his right stands Ākāśagarbha, whose essence is the syllable Trāṃ. Behind him stands the noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord Who Bestows Fearlessness, whose essence is the syllable Hrīm.

Upon the light maṇḍala of the Tathāgata, the vidyās are to be written. Five vases and the eight mantras of the wheel-turning empowerment are to be placed there. Incense and all other offerings are to be charged with the mantras of the all-capable wrathful one, and offerings and so forth are to be arranged; and all protective enclosures likewise.

Then the mantrin himself enters into the practice and, together with the vidyā, invites the noble Sugata with his divine sons and attendants and surrounded by his retinue. Then one bestows empowerment upon oneself, takes the cross-legged posture, and recites one hundred thousand times. One will then behold directly — whether the Tathāgata, or the Vajradhara, or the noble

Avalokiteśvara — and will separately attain the supreme of whatever one desires. If one enters into meditative equipoise at that time, then one will become capable of accomplishing all activities through the power of mind alone.

Then, having formed the mudrā of the Vajradhāriṇī, one generates the pride of identity by reciting: Oṃ vajra-dhara ratna-dhara padma-dhara viśva-dhara tathāgata-samaya mā-tikrama tathāgata-samaya-dhara ātmako'haṃ — "I myself hold the Tathāgata's vajra, the Tathāgata's jewel, the Tathāgata's lotus, the Tathāgata's totality; I do not transgress the Tathāgata's samaya bond; I myself am the holder of the Tathāgata's samaya." Then one introduces the disciples.

Then one has the disciple cast flowers: Oṃ sarva-tathāgata-pratīccha ho samaya stvaṃ — "O all Tathāgatas, receive this; the samaya bond is yours."

Then, with that very garland, one binds it upon the head and bestows empowerment:

Oṃ sarva-tathāgata-abhiṣiṅca vajra-dhara ājñāpaya hūṃ bhrum.

Oṃ vajra vajra abhiṣiṅca hūṃ hūṃ.

Oṃ ratna ratna abhiṣiṅca hūṃ trāṃ.

Oṃ padma padma abhiṣiṅca hūṃ hrīḥ.

Oṃ karma karma abhiṣiṅca hūṃ krum.

Then the empowerment of the samaya and the empowerment of the command are conferred.

The samaya is as follows:

Do not abandon the Three Jewels, the awakening mind,
or the holy spiritual masters.

Do not take the lives of living beings.

Do not take what has not been given.

Do not speak falsehood.

Do not engage with another's woman.

Do not disparage the spiritual master;

do not tread upon his shadow.

Do not follow one who is not a qualified teacher.

Do not utter the name of the vajra master.

Do not disparage mantras or mudrās —

and as for the deities, need it even be said?

If a fool disparages them,
he will most certainly die of disease.
Do not tread underfoot with your feet
the shadows of elders or of gods,
the mudrās, or the marks of syllables
belonging to this world and to that which transcends it.
Those fools who harm the Three Jewels and so forth,
who damage the Buddha's teaching,
and who are devoted to reviling the spiritual master —
the wise should make vigorous effort to slay them.
Those who possess what is contrary to the Dharma, who practice evil —
those who constantly strive to harm sentient beings and who hate their sacred
commitments — these the mantrin, with compassion, should slay through
mantra. The wealth of the fearful should be taken and given as charity to
sentient beings who are destitute.

One should make offerings to the spiritual master, and in that way fulfill one's
sacred commitments. For the sake of the maṇḍala, for the sake of those who
hold sacred commitments, and for the benefit of the bodhisattvas, one may, in
order to make offerings, plunder the wealth of the lords of men or of the
wealthy. By acting for the benefit of sentient beings, and always in accordance
with the sacred commitments of the spiritual master, one may even speak
falsehood in order to protect the lives of living creatures.

In order to please the buddhas, to guard one's sacred commitments, and to
accomplish the knowledge-mantras, one should take recourse to another's
woman. Remaining in the condition of Vajrasattva, even having done
everything and consumed everything, if accomplishment results and no fault
accrues — then for one who possesses compassion, need it even be said?

Then he shall confer the empowerment of command with these words: Om
sarva tathāgata ājñā te dhāsyāmi grhṇa vajra susiddhaye. Om vajra tiṣya hūm.
He shall place the vajra in the hand and confer the activity empowerment
with: Om sarva karmāṇi kuru buddhānām hūm.

Then, for the sake of the spiritual master's being a spiritual master, you should
offer your finest body, your wealth, your property and grain, your seat and
your mount likewise, your finest servant and your house, a king's royal
dominion likewise, son and daughter and wife, mother and sister and niece —

and further, whatever else is desired, all of it. Thinking it to be of benefit, offer it to the spiritual master.

Then, from now until awakening, seeking to accomplish whatever is wished for — from the buddhas themselves and from others, from the great powers of the world — one should supplicate for the attainments (siddhis).

Then, for the benefit of the disciples, the mantrin with a mind free of miserliness and a mind of faith toward those who have faith should bestow the attainments. Having meditated with the mind upon all phenomena as being without inherent existence, one should then visualize the lunar disc arising from the syllable A, and within its center one's own seed-syllable. Having so visualized, one should also visualize the sacred commitment mudrā, and transform the practitioner accordingly into that very state. One should transform him in the manner of the divine yoga. Then one should bless one's own seed-syllable and that mudrā with the mudrā-seal. In due sequence from feet to head, the buddhas confer empowerment.

Then, having aroused the pride of the deity, if one practices with skill, even Tathāgatahood can be achieved — so need it even be said regarding other attainments?

Then Brahmā and the other great gods, bowing before the Blessed One, spoke thus: Blessed One, if kings, princes, royal ministers, the kṣatriya class, brahmins, the merchant class, the commoner class, and also others — those who are low, alone, and of little account, those who sweep, and persons of inferior lineage dwelling on the frontiers — if these enter into this king of maṇḍalas, what will their karmic maturation be like?

The Blessed One declared: Excellent, excellent is this question that has been asked for the benefit and welfare of future sentient beings! Sons of the gods, hear the fruit and maturation for those who enter into this king of maṇḍalas, who receive empowerment, who paint it, who cause others to enter it, who rejoice in it, who pay homage to it, and who make offerings to it.

Sons of the gods, even in brief, I have no capacity to describe its qualities, for even if my own mass of merit were multiplied a thousandfold and a millionfold many times over, it would still not suffice for a reckoning, nor could it be counted, nor could a comparison be made. And equally, even the mass of merit of all the Tathāgatas could not encompass it.

"Blessed One, the fruit and karmic maturation for sentient beings who enter this maṇḍala — that is wondrous, Blessed One! That is wondrous, Vajrapāṇi!" And they rejoiced, saying, "Blessed One, we rejoice in their abiding in the maṇḍala and all the rest. Blessed One, Vajrapāṇi, we rejoice!"

Then those gods bowed down in the same way and spoke these words: "Blessed One, there are sentient beings of Jambudvīpa who have little merit and short lives, who carry the stream of lower rebirths, who have been born in hell realms, as hungry ghosts, and as animals. Blessed One, how shall we act on their behalf?"

The Blessed One replied: "Sons of the gods, let those sentient beings be admitted into this very maṇḍala. Let them also recite the Dharma syllables. By this, those sentient beings will come to have long lives; those who lack merit will come to possess merit; and they will be fully liberated from the lower rebirths.

Sons of the gods, for those who have already been born in the lower rebirths, confer empowerment upon their names. Confer empowerment upon images of them. Confer empowerment upon reliquary shrines. Confer empowerment upon the image of your own deity. If a person is young, confer empowerment upon their kin of the same clan, upon their children, upon those of the same lineage, upon those who bear their name, or upon their servants. Then, having admitted them into the maṇḍala for seven days and conferred empowerment, they will without doubt be fully liberated from the obscurations of the lower rebirths within those seven days.

Sons of the gods, if one recites their name and performs the recitation two hundred thousand times, three hundred thousand times, four hundred thousand times, and up to one hundred million times, even those who have committed the five crimes of immediate retribution (ānantarya) will be fully liberated — so what need is there to speak of those who have committed lesser misdeeds?

Sons of the gods, make the fire-offering pit — the lowest being peaceful, the middle, and the best — measuring one cubit, two cubits, or four cubits, making it round. Then, burning white mustard seed in the person's name one hundred thousand times, they will be fully liberated from all lower rebirths. Likewise, performing the fire-offering with their flesh, bones, hair, ash, and so forth in accordance with that same ritual, they will also be fully liberated from all lower rebirths.

In its center, draw a wheel with eight spokes with blazing white rays. Around it, draw the border with five-pointed vajras, endowed with white rays. Then draw the vajra cross, the vajra jewel, and the supreme lotus. Following that, in order to destroy misdeeds, various mudrās are to be placed. On the outside, draw the seals of the outer vajra families. Also draw the signs of the planets and constellations, and in the same way the world-protectors — whether depicted in the manner of the principal image or otherwise — and place them together with the vajra-holder. Set out birds, filled vases, torii offerings, and pure divine food offerings in white. In brief, having first drawn the grid lines, paint it in accordance with the ritual procedure. Having distributed white cloth, the fearless embodied buddha, recalling sentient beings dwelling in the stream of lower rebirths, and in order to pacify the obscuration of misdeeds, performs the fire-offering of all the buddhas — with butter, milk, and honey mixed with rice, barley, and white mustard seed, along with their bones, flesh, and so forth, or reciting their names — so that they, having been born in the fortunate destinies, will be further developed by the wise.

Making the fire-offering pit four cubits, two cubits, or with four cubits as the superior — and up to eight cubits as the highest — make it square, with a complete border all around. In its center, draw a lotus with a jewel, endowed with yellow rays. In the surrounding border, draw jewels and lotus flowers at the border posts. On the outside, draw the individual seals of the five families. In this way, also draw the outer deities and the hooks and so forth."

Dyeing garments yellow as well,
one recalls those dwelling in the higher realms
and, to benefit them and further their flourishing,
if the rite of flourishing is performed,
that embodied being's lifespan, glory,
splendor, happiness, and enjoyment will increase.

Then again, to truly benefit someone,
if the rite of subjugation is to be performed,
make the fire-offering pit in the shape of a bow —
one cubit, one and a half cubits, or four cubits in size —
and in its center draw a red lotus,
and likewise draw a bow with arrow upon it.
In the surrounding border, draw bows with arrows in red.
With the mantra complete, make the outside
consistently similar in the same way.

Recollecting that sentient being,
have them don garments that have been made red.
With red flowers or lotuses,
red fruits, or dyed pigments
mixed with butter and saffron,
and finally with red sandalwood,
if the fire-offering is performed, gods and all others
will come entirely under that person's power.

Then, to vanquish the spirit-harms that afflict that being,
one should also undertake fierce activity.

Make it half a cubit, or three cubits, or four cubits —
thus the excellent size is nine cubits.

Make it triangular.

In the center, place a nine-pronged vajra,
three-pronged vajras and crossed vajras,
a club with a three-pronged vajra head,
a battle-axe with a single-pointed tip, surrounded by a ring.
On the outside as well, adorn it in three tiers
just as before.

Place birds, torma offerings, vases,
and bali food-offerings in great variety.

Place everywhere skulls filled with flesh and blood.

To vanquish the sins and obstacles of that embodied being,
clothe yourself in black garments, and with wrathful mind
meditate upon yourself as the sovereign of the three worlds.

Then that being's sinful body,
freed from obstacles, may act at ease —
in the higher realms, in the world, among humans,
acting freely in the three realms.

By these very rites in proper sequence,
there is also application in this present life.

Then whatever was done for the sake of a particular person,
for that person too, things will turn out accordingly.

All other rites as well
should be performed just as before.

By this, all sentient beings

will quickly come to experience happiness and joy.

Then the gods, Brahmā and all the others, delighted in mind, bowed to the Blessed One and spoke these words:

Blessed One, for the sake, benefit, and happiness of sentient beings born in the lower realms, we — Brahmā and all the other gods — will guard like our own children those sons or daughters of good family who ask about or engage in asking about this examination king. Whatever kings, princes, and royal ministers follow its instructions as taught, we will cause their royal sovereignty to flourish. We will protect their lands, regions, own subjects, all subjects, and servants. We will cause wealth and grain to arrive in abundance. We will grant them wives, husbands, sons, and daughters. We will make them prosperous, flourishing, with good harvests and at peace. Let alone having no doubts about what has been taught — whatever is desired: whoever, with faith, affixes this examination king to the tip of a victory banner and installs it in villages and towns, and one personally welcomes it and places it upon the back of a great elephant and circumambulates all villages, towns, and so forth — all illness and harm will be no more, and before that great being we will remain in the manner of servants or children.

Wherever this is put into practice, we request that the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi himself enter into the form of a vajrasattva in the saṃbhogakāya —

We request that the Blessed One Vajrasattva Samantabhadra, the fulfiller of all aspirations, be present in the very form of this examination king. We request that all Tathāgatas together with their retinues likewise be present. We request that that very place become a stūpa, and we shall make offerings there, pay homage there, and protect it in every way. We gods — Brahmā and the rest — shall serve as attendants to that vajra master of great austerity who widely expounds this examination king to all. We shall remain in the manner of servants. We shall remain in the manner of those who heed commands. We shall listen to every instruction. We shall perform every benefit and act of well-being. We shall also bestow every spiritual attainment (siddhi). In short, O Blessed One, we shall take the dust of his feet upon our heads. O Blessed One, we shall pay homage. O Blessed One, we shall make offerings. We shall follow in his footsteps. Furthermore, those who have entered the maṇḍala and received empowerment — we request that they too be our lords. We request that they be Vajrapāṇi. We request that they be Vajrasattva. We

request that they be Samantabhadra of great bliss. We request that they be Tathāgata.

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi spoke thus to the gods, Brahmā and the rest: "O gods — Brahmā and the rest — having so pledged by oath to serve the Dharma, this is excellent, excellent! Well accomplished!"

The third and final section.

Then, in order to confirm all mantras, vidyās, and essences, the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi taught this very heart essence:

Om vajra bhrum hūṃ vajrapāṇi ḍḍha tiṣṭha hūṃ om hūṃ a. Om vajra hūṃ phaṭ. Om ḍḍha vajra hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajra hūṃ sa. Om vajra hūṃ aḥ.

Then the maṇḍala for these was described. Draw it like the preceding maṇḍala. In the center, draw a vajra,

or else Vajrasattva,

or Samantabhadra, or Great Bliss.

Before Vajrapāṇi, facing him,

place one holding a jewel in his right hand;

draw the lotus-holder to the west;

to the north, draw one holding a sword.

On the outer ring, surrounding all,

place all the buddhas.

Outside of these, draw the bodhisattvas

in their proper sequence.

Outside of those, draw the great supreme ones —

Maitreya and the rest.

Then, as the monks, Ānanda and the rest:

draw the sages on the outer ring.

Outside of these, draw Brahmā and the rest,

each surrounded by his own wife and sons.

Then the gods of the planets and stars,

the four great kings,

the guardians of the quarters, protectors of the world.

Outside of these, all the hells,

and draw the animals — the beings of desire and the rest.

At each of the gates, as previously taught,

place the supremely powerful gatekeepers.

Golden vases filled with the water of the five fragrances,

radiant and gleaming;
torma offerings and divine food-cakes;
flowers and incense of excellent beauty;
parasols, victory banners, and pennants;
streamers and the finest drums,
bells, vajras, and jewels;
garlands and ornaments of sun, moon, and the like.
Fill the fruit of those who have desires
with the five qualities of sensual enjoyment.

Then the mantra-master himself
shall invite and cause the self-presence to enter.
He himself shall also confer empowerment.
With discipline, possessed of samaya pledges,
devoted to the guru and without fear,
born of noble lineage, free from faults,
having fully abandoned all miserliness,
endowed with many good qualities,
versed in generosity, in ethical conduct, and in much learning,
with a mind of loving-kindness and compassion —
abiding in joy and equanimity,
with a mind of emptiness, signlessness, and wishlessness —
a noble disciple possessed of such a mind
shall, by means of this mantra,
arouse the awakening mind (bodhicitta),
and the mantra-master shall take hold of him.

Oṃ vajra hūṃ jaḥ. Oṃ vajra samaya praveśa hūṃ. Oṃ vajrapāṇi pratīccha
vajrasattva mahāsukha hūṃ. Ha ha ho samaya stvaṃ.

After casting the flower garland, one shall bind the head with the mantra and
mudrā corresponding to whichever flower falls. Then the samaya pledge is to
be conferred:

Oṃ. If you were to reveal this to anyone at all, Vajrapāṇi himself, with a
blazing, fiercely blazing vajra, would shatter your head. Oṃ vajra samaya
dṛḍha hūṃ āḥ.

Then, with the water of the samaya pledge, one shall pour it over him and
remove the blindfold.

Oṃ vajra cakṣuḥ paśya ho. Ājñāpayati pannamokṣayamaṇi hūṃ phaṭ.

Then, revealing all the buddhas and bodhisattvas beginning with Vajrapāṇi, one shall confer empowerment in the presence of the buddhas.

Oṃ vajrapāṇi svayaṃte anurakto abhiṣiṅca hrīḥ. Oṃ vajra vajra abhiṣiṅca sarva vajra abhiṣekata hūṃ āḥ. Oṃ buddha abhiṣiṅca sarva buddhā abhiṣekata oṃ hūṃ. Oṃ ratna abhiṣiṅca sarva ratna abhiṣekata oṃ trāṃ. Oṃ padma abhiṣiṅca sarva padma abhiṣekata oṃ hrīḥ. Oṃ karma abhiṣiṅca sarva karma abhiṣekata oṃ āḥ.

Then one shall offer one's own body and the rest as the fee, and it must be accepted without refusal.

Oṃ sarva tathāgata ājñā abhiṣekata okana te dāsyāmi grhṇa vajra prasiddhaye hūṃ.

Then all activities are to be set in motion, and all siddhis are likewise to be bestowed.

Having generated bliss from bliss,
at the center of the four maṇḍalas,
meditating upon oneself as Samantabhadra
or as Mahāsukha,
if one contemplates hūṃ at the heart,
one becomes equal to Vajrasattva.

Performing all glorious activities,
one becomes Samantabhadra himself —
of this transformation there is no doubt.
If, from hūṃ, the form of a buddha arises,
one becomes the very purity of Vajrapāṇi.
If one meditates upon the wheel vividly at the heart,
one becomes equal to Vajrapāṇi.

Meditating on the vajra wrathful one,
and at the center of the heart, phaṭ —
if one contemplates it encircled by hūṃ,
one becomes the wrathful one of great power.

Transforming oneself into the stable vajra,
with oṃ at the heart,
if one contemplates hūṃ and trāṃ encircling it,

one becomes equal to a jewel.

Meditating on the vajra, and at the center of the heart
contemplating the syllable padma
encircled by oṃ,
one becomes equal to Padmapāṇi.

Generating a wheel with a rim and hūṃ
from the syllable a,
and contemplating it encircled by oṃ,
one becomes equal to the vajra-karma.

Then the activities are to be explained:
the activities of pacification and increase —
likewise those of subjugation and fierce action —
are all to be performed
through recitation, fire offering, and ritual.

Transforming oneself into Vajrasattva,
one undertakes the peaceful activity.
Knowing the rite, in the early morning
one performs recitation and fire offering,
and meditates vividly on rays of light
streaming from that body in clouds.
Always facing east, with rays of light,
one contemplates the dispelling of all faults.
This is done out of love and joy for sentient beings,
from the lineage of the Tathāgata.

Contemplating oneself as the great body of Samantabhadra
or as Mahāsukha,
performing the activity once each morning —
the activity is done as before —
in the early morning, formerly sinful
minds of sentient beings are pacified.

Then, contemplating holding a jewel
beautiful and blazing with golden light,
having prepared good food, in the sun —

At midday, the expanding activity is auspicious.
Dig a pit in the likeness of a jewel,
and perform recitation and fire-offering fully there.
Or else the mantra-holder, as before,
fills the body thoroughly with light.
One who is endowed with the practice
fashions the small pit in the likeness of a lotus,
then transforms oneself into the Lotus-Bearer,
and at the near edge of the sun,
one belonging to oneself
performs recitation and fire-offering,
filling the body with clouds of rays of light,
so that all without exception come under one's power.
By the guide Samantabhadra,
the pacifying activity is performed fully.
The vajra-jewel expanding —
empowerment too is likewise accomplished.

Glorious Vijayā likewise,
the Goddess of Enjoyment-Wealth, Peerless Splendor,
Vajrasūrya of blazing magnificence,
with a complexion exceedingly brilliant aflame —
by laughing and acting wondrously,
all are made rejoicing and delighted.
By the lotus's laughter, all phenomena
are made to be realized, and all buddhas too
are made pleased — what need is there to mention divine servants?
The supreme assembly of others' lineages and so forth
are made to be cut with sharpness.
Spirits, hungry ghosts, demons,
yakṣas, rākṣasas who obey commands,
and the inauspicious ones among the eight supreme planetary lords —
they are expelled from the maṇḍala root and all.
The mute and the non-mute alike,
and fools who cannot speak, are made to speak.
By the syllable Jam upon the tongue,
even the inauspicious are made mute.
With the crossed-thunderbolt, offerings are made

and every aim for sentient beings is taught.
By Hūṃ, emanation is performed,
and by the Vajra-Guardian, protection is made.
By the tooth of Hūṃ,
even Vajrayakṣa himself —
all the inauspicious and utterly inauspicious,
the evildoers — what need to mention them? —
is bound in the heart of the inauspicious,
sealed tight by Bāṃ so contemplated,
and by binding with the vajra-clasp,
poison, plague, spirits, and the like
are placed in bondage.

Through the activities of recitation and fire-offering,
all aims and purposes are accomplished.
By cool rays of light expanding upon things,
one meditates on their increase,
and through the yoga of a peaceful deity
and a peaceful mind, one pacifies.

One's own body, like refined gold
and like the brilliance of the risen sun,
is contemplated, and for the sake of the expanding activity
it is filled with clouds of rays of light.

Through the meditative absorption of the lotus-bodhisattva,
by sending forth rays of light like Hrīḥ,
one circulates them everywhere around the heart,
and all desires are brought under one's power.

Through the meditative absorption of Vajra Hūṃ,
one, in wrath, lets fall a rain of vajra-weapons
upon the bodies of evildoers;
they are immediately destroyed.

Then, having paid homage to the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi, these words were
addressed to him: "Blessed One, it is excellent, excellent, that Vajrapāṇi has
taught this noble tantra that cuts all doubt and reverses all lower rebirths for
the benefit of all sentient beings."

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi taught this chapter on mudrās.

Place both hands forward. Contemplate that the lunar maṇḍala is consecrated by the blessing of Ā, and by Hūṃ and Ā those two consecrate the lunar maṇḍala. Fill and radiate the palms of both hands with the sixteen syllables beginning with Ā.

On the two thumbs, place the syllable Oṃ in contemplation. On the two index fingers, place Hūṃ. On the two middle fingers, place Trāṃ. On the two ring fingers, place Hrīḥ. On the two little fingers, place Ā.

Having thus placed the syllables, generate the conviction that they are Tathāgatas. Recollecting that all phenomena are blended one with another and that they accord with oneself, join the two hands in the likeness of a lotus, extend the two Oṃ-fingers, and bend the two Ā-fingers. Likewise, the two Hūṃ and the two Hrīḥ fingers are made to resemble the petals of a lotus.

The two Trāṃ fingers are crossed and extended. This is the samaya endowed with all things, derived from the root mudrā of the Blessed One. That same mudrā made sharp is the wheel mudrā. Made to resemble a wheel spinning freely from that same base, it is the wheel mudrā. That same mudrā placed at the mouth is the speech mudrā. These together constitute the assembly of mudrās. When that same mudrā is made twofold and fashioned into a karma mudrā, it becomes the karma mudrā.

The left hand resembling a held skull-cup,
The right like a short trident with three points,
The left like a half-opened lotus,
The right placed in the form called Oṃ.

The left a wheel with three zones of bliss,
The Ā and Oṃ brought tip to tip,
The remaining three adorned with vajra form,
The Oṃ and Hūṃ bent inward,
The rest made straight — this is the arrow mudrā.

Both right and left hands formed as wheels,
The radiance showing the face of sun and moon,
The palms joined together, fingers spread,
The remnant planets ever caught in eclipse.

That same mudrā, spoken of as the word empowerment,
Is placed at the mouth in the form of issuing speech.
The elbow, open and at ease, is joyful;

The arm extended holds the staff.

The bull-nāga's nose resembles a crocodile (makara).

That which is to be known resembles a meteor like a shooting star.

When that same mudrā is rotated, it becomes the lightning-garland mudrā.

Placed above and below, it is the cloud mudrā.

These are the mudrās of the essence; the karma mudrās are likewise these same mudrās.

From that same base, the two ring fingers bound together form the mudrā of Vajrapāṇi.

From that same base, the Hūṃ without breaking the syllable in the middle is what bestows empowerment — this is the mudrā of Ākāśagarbha.

From that same base, the Hūṃ bound together with the ring fingers made to resemble a lotus — this is the mudrā arisen from the lotus.

From that same base, the two — Hūṃ and Hrīḥ — crossed and raised: this is the mudrā of the Blessed One Vajrasattva.

From that same base, made to resemble a lotus: this is the mudrā of great bliss.

From that same base, fashioned in the manner of radiating light-rays: this is the mudrā of Samantabhadra.

That same mudrā drawn inward: this is the blazing mudrā of the various wrathful ones.

From that same base, held very firmly: this is vajra-bound. Extended: this is the blazing mudrā.

The teeth of Hūṃ belong to the yakṣas. The two Hūṃ fingers made into hooks constitute the summoning mudrā. Those same fingers made straight form the desire mudrā. Hūṃ and Oṃ joined together form the rejoicing mudrā. That same mudrā fashioned in the likeness of a maṇḍala forms the majestic mudrā. Made to resemble a jewel, it is the victory-banner mudrā. Rotated, it is the laughing mudrā. That same mudrā placed at the mouth is the wonder of causing joy and smiling. The palms drawn inward to resemble a lotus form the lotus mudrā. Ā and Oṃ drawn inward form the sword mudrā. One joined with the other is the wheel mudrā. From the former, the two Oṃ fingers placed at the mouth produce issuing speech. In brief, all these mudrās bestow the

accomplishment of all activities.

That same mudrā, contracted and knotted, becomes a serpent's head.

Everywhere resembling the fangs of a yakṣa,

The rākṣasa's blood-seizing mudrā,

The hands rotated form the wind mudrā,

Endowed with a club, this belongs to the yakṣas.

Placed at the vase, it is the wealth mudrā.

The thumb is to be made like the tip of a shrew's nose.

The skull atop the head belongs to the black one.

Bhṛdgiṛiti — the hand extended,

The lute held in the left hand belongs to the gandharvas.

Both hands blazing, fire burning,

The forearm club-like belongs to Yama.

Sharp, wrathful, and commanding,

The little finger a sword, the index finger a lasso —

The wind mudrā is the victory banner.

These and similar mudrās

Are born and arise from the hands.

Common to all the gods,

The lotus mudrā is auspicious.

For the nāgas, the emblem to be known is the blue lotus (utpala).

And so the teeth belong to the yakṣas.

The tufted hair on the head belongs to the rākṣasas.

The ten fingers interlaced belongs to women.

The club belongs to the planetary spirits.

The offering of arghya water belongs to the asterisms.

All of these accomplish the mind of those beings.

The mudrā of a skull held at the mouth

Is said to belong to Prajñāntakā.

The mudrā of the skull tongue

Is declared to belong to the Vajrayoginī.

All of these in common

Are to be explained as the great mudrā (mahāmudrā).

The flat open palm is described,

Or else the palm may be made into a lotus.

Forming the vajra fist and binding it,
With Ā held in a chain,
And Hūṃ with both raised —
This is the mudrā of Vajrapāṇi.

Binding with the vajra bond,
And crossing and raising both Hūṃ and Ā,
The mudrā in which Oṃ is brought face to face —
Understand this to be the one that produces light.

From that, Ā is bound,
And Oṃ is inserted within.
Oṃ is applied as before.
Oṃ too is made like Ā.

Trāṃ is crossed,
And both Ā and Oṃ are held in a chain.
Hūṃ with both raised,
And the remaining crossed — this mudrā
Is to be known as the coiling of nectar.

Trāṃ is crossed,
And Hūṃ likewise in the same way.
Thus with Hūṃ crossed,
The remainder is to be made like rays of light.

Whatever the mudrā of Hayagrīva may be,
It too is declared for all activities.
Locanā's is described as resembling an eye.
Māmakī's is like a vajra.
White Pāṇḍarā is declared to be a lotus.
The blue lotus (utpala) is understood to be Tārā.

Sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa sa.
Ba ba ba ba ba ba ba ba ba ba ba ba ba ba ba ba.
Dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra dzra.
Twa twa twa twa twa twa twa twa twa twa twa twa twa twa twa twa twa.
Hūṃ. Ja. Ho. Dhu. Trāṃ. Ryaṃ. Bhri. Hā. Hrīḥ. Dhīḥ. Kruṃ. Bhaṃ. Kaṃ. Raṃ.
Kṣaṃ. Saṃ.

Oṃ buddhalocane hūṃ.

Oṃ vajramāmakī trāṃ.

Oṃ vajrapāṇḍare dehi dehi siddhi bodhi na lokoṭṭarambā svāhā.

Oṃ vajratāre tuttāre ture hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ svā svā svā svā hā.

The striking for pacification: Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat. Śambhat.

The striking for increase: Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ. Ghuṃ.

The striking for power: Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma. Ho dhuma.

The striking for fierce activity: Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ. Khatvaṃ.

Then all the gods, filled with joy,

Paid homage to Vajrapāṇi

And beseeched him earnestly

To teach the wrathful wheel.

Then the Blessed One Vajrapāṇi cast off his own body, entered into the form of Vajrasattva, and entered into meditative absorption called Equal in Non-Duality. From the heart of Vajrasattva's wrathful form he drew forth this very essence, the Fiery Vajra Sun of the Wrathful One:

Oṃ vajrasattva krodhānalārkamahāvajrakrodha draba draba, bidraba bidraba, sarvapāya nāśaya nāśaya, hara hara prāṇāna hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ trailokyāloka kāraya hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ trailokyadamaka hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ trailokyanāśana hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ trailokyabandhaka hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ amṛte hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kāladaṇḍa hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kānidhuni hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ hrīḥ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kālāṅkuśa hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kālāpāśa hūṃ phaṭ.

Oṃ kālabandha hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kālarākṣasa hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kālarākṣasī hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kāladaṇḍī hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kālarātri hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ kālayakṣiṇī hūṃ phaṭ.

Then the maṇḍala, unbearable and supreme in its greatness, with twelve spokes, is encircled by a garland of blazing divine substances, flaming intensely and blazing enormously. Having drawn the maṇḍala in this way,

Vajrasattva is to be placed within it. All the wrathful ones — Illuminator of the Three Worlds and the rest — press down upon the hearts of the malevolent and make the gesture of menace; their faces are exceedingly fearsome to behold; they have many hundreds of hands; they are adorned with serpents and hideous heads; they are clad in tiger-skin skirts; they hold entrails and have boundless, countless heads; and skulls filled to the brim they hold in their hands. Having drawn them thus, the assemblies of rākṣasīs are to be placed on the outside. The gatekeepers are each as they should be, bearing the hand-emblems of their own mudrās.

Then sixteen vases filled with nectar (amṛta) are to be placed. Incense, flowers, sweet fragrance, lamps, offering vessels, food-filled tormas, cakes, things to eat and to taste, and what is called nectar — all of these, filling skulls to the brim, are to be arrayed in abundance within the maṇḍala.

Then the master himself, with joyful confidence, seals the skull with the mudrā. With that mudrā, and the others, he bestows the samaya pledge of all the flesh-offerings. Then, having obtained what is desired, the accomplishment is to be performed with the syllable hūṃ. After that, the mantra practitioner, at each and every gate, is to approach and recollect that very reality. This is certainly the accomplishment: in but a moment one gains sovereignty over the three worlds.

Within the maṇḍala, to the assembled retinues and to the assemblies of one's own deity, the samaya vow that arises from the tantra is to be recited. Then, having made offerings, one rises, and, dwelling in the mode of the assembly-summoner Vajrasattva, one departs. Then, having gathered the disciples, they are led in holding a precious jewel in the hand.

Om vajrakrodha samaya hūṃ. Om vajrarākṣasī hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajrakrodhānalārka sphuṭaratā prātīccha hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajrakrodha nirākṣa hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajrakrodha pāśa hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajrakrodha samayanirvīra hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajrakrodha samayamatikrama hūṃ phaṭ. Om vajrakrodha rati samaya abhiṣiñca hūṃ phaṭ.

With these, empowerment is conferred, and empowerment is to be conferred in the same manner. Then the practice performed by them is explained.

Having entered into meditative absorption as the wrathful deity oneself, then one visualizes a sun at the heart. From one's own Dharma syllable, in wrathful agitation, rays stream forth again and again. These two are to be meditated upon as one. Only then will accomplishment come; it will not come otherwise.

Although it is said that the actual activity of the Wrathful King is slaying, pacification, subjugation, and enrichment — all of these, without doubt, it will assuredly accomplish.

Abiding in the meditative absorption of Vajrasattva, if one meditates on the wrathful maṇḍala, one seizes malevolent sentient beings and, in short, things such as pestilence, demons, and poison — all of these, annihilated through skillful means and the rest. One should contemplate the act of slaying as arising wrathfully from the heart. Imagining that the shriek of the enraged vulture-woman extracts flesh and blood and takes away the life of those beings, they will certainly be destroyed.

The Wrathful Illuminator of the Three Worlds — meditating on him with virtue of mind, like the moon, and contemplating him as pervaded by many streaming rays of light — with those very rays one expels pestilence, demons, poison, and the like, and casts far away the sickness, aging, and harm of those beings, in order to pacify them.

Then, placing the syllable hūṃ, one visualizes the body as vajra-like and makes armor from the wheel of the syllable haṃ. With rays of light as water, empowerment is conferred. Then, pronouncing that one's own name, one meditates properly through recitation. Then, as for the three apertures, they are like a full moon with streaming rays of light —

about a cubit or perhaps a cubit and a half — one doubles these for the best of human kings. Having thoroughly purified those sites, in the center of a wheel-shaped maṇḍala, within a lunar disc, one places a single vajra-point, radiant and encircled by a garland of white rays of light.

All the groups of mudrās are to be drawn: the mudrā of the hundred families and the like extend outward at the corners; the emblems of the four kings are drawn accordingly; and the lords of the directions are drawn in their respective directions. The mudrā of the Great God (Śiva) and others, pervading and entering, and that which is like a wheel — all these are to be drawn.

Eight vases filled with fragrant water, shining with a white, luminous color, and most thoroughly purified with whiteness; tormas and offering cakes filled with the three white substances; incense, lamps, and flowers — all these are to be arranged. For the purpose of making offerings, one places a canopy and, likewise, a parasol, a victory banner, a yak-tail fan, and so forth. The interior is anointed with fragrant camphor-mixed unguents and sandalwood paste and

the like.

Facing east, one performs the fire offering. One should be seated upon the seat of a Tathāgata, or else upon the seat of one who possesses yoga and the mind of a bodhisattva — garments and the like adorned with white garlands of white.

Butter, honey, and milk; barley porridge and the like; sesame oil and sesame seeds; white mustard, rice, and beans; husked rice, barley, and wheat; and flowers of exceedingly sweet fragrance — these are mixed with camphor and smeared with white sandalwood. Seven-petaled flowers and fruits, placed upon a milky wood — these are to be measured by one's own finger-widths according to their particular dimensions: twenty-four finger-widths is the best, sixteen is the middling, and twelve is known to be the least; if it is very small, eight finger-widths. The milky wood is to be understood as anointed with scented water.

Having kindled the fire born from that wood, and scattered scented water, one who is auspicious in countenance like a white lotus, holding a lotus and a jewel orb, holding an excellent staff in hand, and seated upon a seat of white lotus — such a fire deity is invited, and an arghya offering is received and presented to him.

Then, from the white full moon, the benefactor of beings who abides therein is invited and, visualizing a white lotus in the eastern direction, is placed above.

Then, having thus visualized, the object of accomplishment is always kept before one; its faults are drawn out and concealed with great care.

In the morning, first becoming pure, one anoints the body with exceedingly fragrant substances; and, visualizing these as nectar, one performs the fire offering. This samaya is exceedingly difficult to transgress. These five nectars, the divine substances — first examining the fire deity, one invites that wrathful one into that very body and visualizes him as dwelling there. Then, at the outset, one offers three oblations to the wrathful one, then three to the Three Jewels, then three to the fire deity himself, then to Vajrasattva, then to each of the deities one by one, then one offers to the obstructers and the like — or to whatever deity is desired. Then one performs the fire offering of the milky wood with the mantra of the wrathful one. Then, having mixed them together and consecrated them with the nectar mantra, following that same fire offering, one offers — up to a hundred thousand, or else up to one hundred and eight times — to the wrathful one. One confers empowerment upon that

body, and, guarding it with meditative equipoise, at the end, having made a final offering of honor, one requests all the deities to depart.

By this, even peaceful activities will be accomplished — of this there is no doubt. But if one is sinful or has not remained in meditative equipoise, and thus the siddhi has not arisen, one should cultivate emptiness, and then, having performed it again in the same manner —

the siddhi will infallibly arise. Such is the peaceful rite.

For the rite of increase, one should work with a joyful mind in a fruit-bearing grove, or alternatively in a forest, or in the home of a king or of royal lineage.

The fire pit should measure one cubit, or four cubits, and the finest measure is eight cubits — one of these, from the smallest to the finest, with the intermediate sizes in between, is to be used for the rite of increase.

In brief, for the fire offering pit, one builds a platform and a maṇḍala. The smallest maṇḍala is eight cubits across, the intermediate is twelve cubits, the finest is sixteen cubits, and one should know it may also be twenty-four. The border surround should be eight, sixteen, or thirty-two finger-breadths wide. Half the width of this outer ring is to be adorned with lotus designs. The center of the maṇḍala is to be adorned with various jewels and lotuses.

At the center of this, one digs — having examined the ground carefully — a pit half the full measure in depth: four cubits, or eight cubits, or shaped like an auspicious lotus in full bloom. In brief, one uses yellow clay to dig the finest pit in this way, and then coats it with saffron and the like. In the center of the pit, one paints and coats it with the finest yellow pigment, and one visualizes it as shining like golden light.

Then, using red-gold pigments, one draws, filling the entire surrounding ring of the maṇḍala, the mudrā-maṇḍalas of the jewel, the lotus, and so forth — all present within it. Whether the maṇḍala has two tiers, four tiers, or eight tiers, one should recognize each of its gates as taking the form of a mudrā.

One takes a vase, golden in color and completely filled with perfumed water, beautifully adorned with eighty-two or thirty-two or sixteen excellent ornaments. It is wrapped with yellow silk, adorned at the mouth with flowering branches, with sweet-smelling flowers and incense, garlands, lamps, and various ornaments, victory banners, hanging banners, and the like, and decorated with yellow canopies and parasols. Oneself, too, is adorned with garments, ornaments, flowers, and so forth, all in yellow.

Then, seated facing north, one recalls the yoga of the wrathful one who tames the three worlds, together with the divine wish-fulfilling jewel royal banner, blazing like golden light — and likewise the sun, the moon, Kubera, yakṣas, and Jambhala, who shower down a rain of gold and fulfill every wish of the heart. One contemplates that it is through the rays of his light that empowerment is conferred without fail.

Thereby, obtaining sovereignty over a kingdom goes without saying — what need is there even to mention the increase of the body? For the purpose of increase, one calls upon him by name and recites one hundred times one hundred and eight, or in the same manner, one thousand one hundred and eight times.

After that, one performs the fire offering. To the north, upon a lion throne, on a seat of jewel, lotus, sun, and moon, adorned with all ornaments: vajra jewel, the supreme jewel, the jewel of glory, supreme splendor, vajra-laughter, and the Victorious — and adorned with all manner of ornaments — the deity's right hand inclines in the gesture of supreme giving, while golden rays blaze and stream forth in every direction. One contemplates that they fully permeate everything.

Having made offerings with conch shells, lutes, flutes, cymbals, song, and sublime dance — in brief, having made these offerings — one then undertakes the activity beneath it.

Regarding the distinction of the pit, one should also distinguish the wood of the fire from the fuel wood according to their type. A thumb's length, or a closed fist's length, or one cubit — these are described as the smallest measure. The intermediate, one should know, is one and a half cubits. Four cubits is the finest measure.

One places within the pit the appropriate flowers and fruits of the lineage, together with honey. All the grains in their abundance, with yellow flowers and fruits, are mixed with butter and honey — and largely with fruits of auspicious fortune.

The fire deity, resembling gold, with four arms — here in the same manner, seated upon a lotus throne, fully adorned — is invited, and the fire offering is offered to him.

Into that body of the fire deity, the wrathful king is well and properly installed with his blessing. Recalling as before, one examines the fire offering fully,

directing it into his mouth.

Through one hundred thousand or even two hundred thousand oblations, the aim is certainly and perfectly accomplished. Through ten million oblations, kingship or an abundance of prosperity and enjoyment is achieved.

Then at the conclusion, by means of rays of light, empowerment is conferred upon him and he is protected. Through this he shall become a sovereign — in accordance with the command of Vajrapāṇi.

This is the rite of enrichment.

Empowerment is to be performed with a mind of desire and with meditative absorption of desire. The Blessed One of Desire who holds the vajra, and Vajrarāga, arose from that. Because he causes desire throughout the three realms, the bodhisattva Padma is eternally passionate. It is therefore said that through this, those rites are accomplished.

One should go to a place that accords with desire, or to a dwelling that generates desire. In a household bearing kitchen fires or a moonlit name, one performs the rites of desire. Or equally, a place that pleases the mind, or a dwelling of Vajrarāga — truly the very abode of the Lotus-Holder — always the abode of the vajra-being, the great abode of great bliss, lakes of lotuses and utpalas, a place of bandhu flowers, a grove of red flowers and fruits, pleasant and desire-arousing to the mind.

There one constructs a platform of eight cubits, or in the same manner twelve or sixteen cubits, and at its center one makes the fire-pit maṇḍala — of one cubit, or half a cubit, or four cubits in the same way. It should be made to resemble a bow, a lotus, or equally a vajra. Like an arrow, or like a lunar crescent, or in the same way like a lotus petal. In width, the measure of half the length of water; in depth, one digs the fire pit to half the measure of its width. The rim should be four finger-breadths. What is double should be made double. As for the distinction of the finest and last, the fire-wood logs should each be recognized separately.

As for the measure of fire-wood logs and fuel wood, it is taught for the rite of pacification. Extremely red sandalwood, or any other red wood, are equally suitable. Red flowers and fruits, lac, sandalwood, saffron, and the like; valerian resin and saffron — in brief, with fragrant wood and smoldering wood, the fire-wood logs too are anointed with yellow mustard of red hue, lac, and vermilion likewise, copper powder and mustard, the grain of long life, salt,

sesame, fragrant drop-seeds, la-phug, mustard husks, and likewise blood and great dust — all these are gathered together for burning.

Then, having repeatedly anointed them with the juice of the fruits and so forth explained before, having consecrated them with the mantra of the wrathful one, one fills them with freshly churned butter from cow and goat, along with butter and sesame oil. Perfumed with camphor and the like, one places them after adding nectar.

Then the fire pit, which is red, one envisions as resembling a coral trunk, and anoints it with red incense and the like, along with red saffron. Then one coats it thickly with red pigment. With a paint mixed with yellow saffron, one draws the designs.

Inside the fire pit, one draws a lotus; above it, a bow with an arrow. Always, all around the fire pit, one draws lotuses continuously. In the center of the bow, one draws a vajra; around the rim, one draws arrows. Outside the bow, one draws a lotus; above it, an arrow. On the outside of that, one draws a vajra, a hook, and a bow adorned with an iron goad. On the southern side, one draws a victory banner, a jewel, and a splendid maṇḍala. Lotuses, swords, and wheels are to be drawn on the western side. The finest vajra fang and supreme armor are to be drawn on the northern side. In the corners, incense and so forth.

One is to draw them in the form of mudrās, and to make offerings just as before, with red flowers and the like. Having anointed with red fragrance, with splendid garments and garlands, one should always face west toward the Sage, performing the rite without interruption of the red cord. Visualizing a red lotus seat, one imagines Avalokiteśvara, deeply attached, holding a lotus in hand. On his left is Vajra-Attachment, on his right is Great Bliss. Visualizing thus, in the center between them one places the bearer of the makara banner. The vajra bow and the Sinuous Lady, Joyful Lady adorned with red flowers, are to be lavishly worshipped with red fragrance and the like. Likewise, one who holds arrow and bow, and who bears a red lotus and staff — the fire deity is to be summoned, and the Wrathful King is to be skillfully inserted into that deity's body and established there. Having transformed him through rays of light, the deity's body is bound with vajra iron hook and noose, and summoned, then the crown of his head is placed at the feet of the master. Having thus visualized and entered into meditative absorption, whatever rite is performed thereby — by that, even the gods come under one's power; what need is there to speak of humans and asuras? When the rites have been accomplished and one has

made the mind one of attachment, one fills the crown of the head with that deity's rays of light. Having retained that, one is to release it. Then, with vajra desire, one makes offerings to the gods and requests their departure. After that, having performed the protection, one who has vajra desire should always recite. This is the subjugation rite.

Then, with Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, and the other gods prostrating again and again, and having made various supreme offerings such as precious parasols and the rest, one praises the sovereign of all, Vajrapāṇi, the lord of vajra, with a mind of joy:

You who were awakened before all buddhas,
who have slain every stain of ignorance —
Vajra, vajra, lord who holds the vajra,
vajra, vajra, vajra-holder.
Vajra-body, great of body —
to Vajrapāṇi I bow in praise.

Vajra-limb, supreme among vajras,
blazing vajra, greatly blazing,
vajra force, mighty in force,
vajra weapon, great vajra.
Vajrapāṇi of the great gesture,
vajra arrow that supremely pierces,
vajra keen, supremely sharp.
Great of greatness, great ocean,
vajra lotus, great awakening,
the awakening mind expanded, self-arisen.
Great expanse of vajra, vast and wide,
purifier of vajra illusion,
vajra cause, great yakṣa,
purifier of vajra lotus.
Vajra wrathful, supremely fierce,
vajra chief who crushes hostile foes,
vajra terrifying, great protector,
vajra hook that accomplishes purpose.
Vajra zombie, supremely risen zombie,
vajra rākṣasa, profoundly deep,
vajra yakṣa, great yakṣa,
vajra spirit, supremely great spirit.

Terrifying, delighting, greatly fierce,
vajra terrifier, mantra maker,
excellent through accomplishing the difficult to accomplish —
vajra excellence, maker of joy,
vajra joy, supremely joyful,
vajra of joy, the mighty one.
Vajra splendor, supremely splendid,
blazing with light, lord of death who brings all to an end,
vajra fierce, greatly fierce,
dense with light and thus supremely dense,
equal to the sky itself,
fulfiller of all hopes.
Vajra empowerment, supreme jewel,
vajra victory banner, supreme excellence,
vajra wisdom, greatly wise,
surrounded by hosts of millions of vidyās.
Hala hala, greatly dark,
loud-resounding and a destroyer.
Vajra desire, greatly desiring,
purifier of troubled and evil times,
instantly moving, cutting through doubt,
flashing like lightning from the tongue of his mouth.
Vajra fire that tames the intractable,
supremely fierce, illuminator of great radiance,
his face scorched by a thousand suns,
his eyes red, a maker of terror.
Many wrathful ones radiate like light;
his many hands bear a hundred weapons.
His body is a thousand, with many faces,
coiling and swirling with ornaments that coil.
By the nature of mind he has no body;
he has abandoned conceptual thought without remainder.
The Brahmā who vanquishes ignorance,
who brings attachment and aversion to their final end.
Illusory, yet possessing the vajra of desire,
three-pointed, three-pointed, grasping and seizing,

with great attachment, aversion, and delusion,
purifying existence and non-existence alike.
Peaceful and tamed, delighting in joy,
a buddha, supremely realizing buddhahood,
whose very self is buddha, whose body is buddha,
supremely born of vajra, mind of vajra.
Samantabhadra, greatly excellent,
adorned with marks that are supremely noble.
Pervader whose very self is the three realms,
entirely of vajra nature, entirely pure.

Whoever writes or recites this,
or always bears its meaning in mind,
or merely recollects it or listens to it —
that person shall become like Vajrapāṇi.

When the Blessed One had spoken these words, Śakra (Indra), Brahmā, and all the other gods, humans, asuras, gandharvas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, and the rest rejoiced at what the Blessed One had proclaimed and praised it with delight. The Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha, all lower realms —

Translator's Notes

- The opening Sanskrit title is transcribed in Tibetan phonetic script and has been restored here in reconstructed Sanskrit for clarity. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, corresponding to a question Śakra is in the process of asking, and the translation preserves that open ending faithfully.

The phrase rendered "hair-tuft at the brow" translates the Tibetan for ūrṇā, the tuft of white hair between the eyebrows traditionally regarded as one of the major marks of a great being. Here it belongs syntactically to a bodhisattva's radiance emanating from the meditative absorption itself; the grammar is unusual and the referent of "that very same bodhisattva" is somewhat elliptical in context, most likely referring to the Great Brahmā in his capacity as a great bodhisattva.

- The phrase rendered "unequalled and equal to the unequalled" translates the Tibetan "mi mnyam pa dang mnyam pa," a standard epithet in Buddhist literature meaning "equal to the one who has no equal" — that is, the buddhas share among themselves the quality of being supreme and without peer. This is a recognized doctrinal formulation and not an error in the text.

- The Sanskrit mantras are preserved exactly as they appear in the Tibetan transliteration, following standard practice in Tibetan dhāraṇī texts. The term translated as "essence" throughout is "snying po," which in this context carries the technical meaning of heart-essence or dhāraṇī-essence, equivalent to Sanskrit hṛdaya. The phrase rendered "near-essence" (nye

ba'i snying po) corresponds to the Sanskrit upaḥṛdaya, a secondary or subsidiary dhāraṇī formula. The title "King Who Thoroughly Purifies All Lower Realms" renders sdig pa thams cad rnam par sbyong ba'i rgyal po, which designates the dhāraṇī itself as a sovereign purificatory force.

- The phrase rendered "turn their backs upon every lower realm" translates a Tibetan idiom meaning to have one's back turned to, that is, to face away from and abandon, the lower rebirths. The passage distinguishes between an "inner" or "root" maṇḍala just proclaimed and an "outer maṇḍala" about to be given, a standard structural division in this class of purification tantra texts. The eight untimely deaths are a standard enumeration of inauspicious or untimely modes of dying that recur throughout this textual tradition.
- The deity name Sarvavid rendered as "the All-Knowing One" with the Sanskrit retained in parentheses on first use; this is Vairocana in his Sarvavid form, a central figure in the Uṣṇīṣavijayā and related Yoga Tantra maṇḍalas. The "King who purifies all lower realms" (འཇམ་མཛོད་ཀྱི་རྒྱལ་པོ་) refers to the principal deity of the larger cycle, consistent with the preceding passage.

The term 有難障者 (vināyaka) designates a class of obstacle-causing spirits; rendered as "vināyakas" in Sanskrit since no single clean English equivalent exists.

The term कम्बहन्दा (kumbhānda) is a class of spirit; retained in Sanskrit transcription.

- The passage includes a flower-casting divination rite in which a blindfolded initiate casts flowers onto a maṇḍala; the family of deity upon whom the flower lands indicates the disciple's karmic family and determines the siddhi to be pursued. This is standard in Vajrayāna initiation liturgy.

The mantra syllables Jaḥ Hūṃ Baṃ Hoḥ are the four action mantras of invitation, binding, attraction, and satisfaction used to invite wisdom beings into the maṇḍala; they are left untranslated as is standard practice.

The Sanskrit mantras embedded in the text are rendered as they appear in the Tibetan transliteration, with minor normalization to standard Sanskrit orthography where the meaning is clear.

- The phrase rendered "sovereign of vision" for Avalokiteśvara glosses 觀世音菩薩, a word meaning "lord" or "sovereign," used here as a modifier. Some editions read this differently but the sense is standard.

The term साधना is rendered "sādhana rite" in the prose narrative; the Sanskrit sādhana (a liturgical accomplishment text) is the most natural equivalent here.

"Locanā" renders ལོཙ་ན་པ་ — this is the goddess Locanā (Skt. Locanā), one of the four buddha-consort goddesses in the mandala; the Tibetan is a phonetic rendering of the Sanskrit.

The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end, as in the source; this is intentional and not a translation error.

- The phrase rendered "session after session, without break" translates the Tibetan meaning "single-sign, striking-and-reciting," which in context refers to continuous, uninterrupted recitation. The exact technical sense of the compound is somewhat idiomatic but the translation captures the practical instruction.

The repeated phrase "signs of existence" in the final verse may refer to marks or characteristics of the realms of cyclic existence in which the being is born. The verse is clearly incomplete as given, ending mid-sentence, so no conclusion is rendered.

The numbers given for recitation counts — three hundred thousand, six hundred thousand, eight hundred, one hundred and eight, one hundred thousand, ten million, one thousand hundred-thousands — follow the Tibetan exactly and are characteristic of this genre of sādhanā literature.

- The term rendered "bali offering" translates "byin za," which is a ritual food or torma offering made to spirits or deities; "bali" is the standard Sanskrit equivalent used in this tantric context.

The phrase "Sarvavid" renders the Sanskrit Sarvavid, meaning "all-knowing" or "omniscient," here functioning as a name or seed-mantra of Vairocana in his Sarvavid aspect, central to purification rites of this type. The Tibetan "ཀླུ་མཁའ་ལྷོ་མཆོག་" is a phonetic transcription of Sanskrit sarvavid.

The line "birds and full vases" reflects the Tibetan "bya dang bum pa gang ba" — "bya" here most likely refers to auspicious bird figures or bird-shaped offerings used in maṇḍala decoration, though the exact referent is somewhat uncertain in context.

- The phrase rendered "the white-faced Lotus" refers to a deity associated with a white lotus aspect, most likely Avalokiteśvara or a related lotus-bearing figure; the Tibetan is "Padma's white face" and the referent is contextually Padmapāṇi or similar. The section on the "sinful continuum" and the signs is a technical purification rite within the Kriyā or Caryā tantra genre, and the precise boundaries of who is speaking shift; the declaration at the end is attributed directly to the Sugata. The list of five grave offenses alluded to near the end partially overlaps with the five acts of immediate retribution but is here expanded with tantric categories including killing those free from attachment, a reference to killing arhats.

- The term rendered "uninterrupted hells" refers to Avīci, the most extreme of the hell realms, characterized by uninterrupted suffering. The Tibetan "མཆོག་མཁའ་ལྷོ་མཆོག་" (literally "without interval") is the standard translation of Skt. anantarya / avīci in this context.

The phrase "drums the size of a chariot-wheel" renders "ཀླུ་མཁའ་ལྷོ་མཆོག་ཀླུ་མཁའ་ལྷོ་མཆོག་" — bounding drum-heads likened to the hub or wheel of a chariot; the exact instrument is uncertain but "drum" is the most natural rendering.

The name Vimalaraśmi Ratna is reconstructed from the Tibetan "ཀླུ་མཁའ་ལྷོ་མཆོག་ཀླུ་མཁའ་ལྷོ་མཆོག་" — literally "Jewel, Stainless Radiance"; this represents a plausible but unverified Sanskrit equivalent.

- The phrase rendered "crimes of immediate retribution" refers to the five ānantarya-karmas, the most grievous acts in Buddhist ethics that bring immediate karmic consequence without an intervening rebirth; this is the standard doctrinal referent of the Tibetan term used here.

The creature translated as "makara" is the mythological aquatic beast of Indian tradition, here appearing in a list of animals offered as mounts; it is left in Sanskrit as it has no satisfactory English equivalent.

- The name "Harītī" is rendered from the Tibetan "Phrog ma" literally meaning "the Snatcher," a well-known yakṣinī figure in the Buddhist tradition; she is identified by her five-hundred children and her association with Pañcika, which confirms the identification. The passage ends mid-sentence in the source text, reflecting that this is a portion of a longer discourse; no translation is added beyond what the Tibetan supplies.

- The dhāraṇī syllables are transliterated from the Tibetan phonetic rendering of Sanskrit mantra language. Variant spellings within this corpus are common and reflect the Tibetan transmission. The mantras are reproduced as they stand without normalization, as standardization would alter a liturgical document.

The phrase rendered "he drew forth from the very heart of this dhāraṇī" understands "rang gi snying po" to refer to the dhāraṇī text itself (its heart-essence), with Vajrapāṇi extracting these

mantras from within it — a standard tantric formulation for revealing embedded seed-mantras.

- The directional assignment of the deities follows a maṇḍala layout. The term "Vijaya" (rnam par rgyal ba) appears twice in close succession and likely refers to two distinct deities or forms; the second occurrence is paired with the southwest direction and is associated with Nairṛtya, a directional deity of the southwest. The first occurrence, to the left, is the bodhisattva Vijaya.

The passage ends mid-sentence, which reflects a break in the source text.

- The phrase rendered "the mudrā of excellent intelligence" translates a term literally meaning "good intellect" or "good understanding," which likely corresponds to a specific deity or quality in the maṇḍala system; the translation follows the literal sense. The passage shifts from highly compressed, formulaic mudrā descriptions to a brief transition into image-ritual procedure; the final sentences are clearly a pivot toward a new topic. "Arghya" is kept in parenthetical form at first use as it refers to the ritual water-offering vessel or liquid, a term sufficiently technical to warrant identification.

- The phrase rendered "the domain of the buddhas, the domain of the buddhas" reflects what appears to be a repeated compound in the Tibetan. This repetition may be a scribal dittography or an intentional emphatic construction; the translation preserves it as it stands.

The sage's name "Maitrī" is the Sanskrit equivalent of the Tibetan Byams pa, meaning loving-kindness or Maitreya; here it functions as a personal name for the sage and is rendered accordingly.

- The name "Śacikā" rendered for the mother figure follows the Tibetan "sha tsi ka" — this is the Tibetan transliteration of Sanskrit Śacī or Śacikā, another name for Indrāṇī, the consort of Indra. The identification here is straightforward in context.

The ten names or epithets in the dhāraṇī invocation section appear as a phonetic string (Koṭa Koṭa Kṣa, etc.) in the Tibetan. These are Sanskrit mantra syllables transliterated into Tibetan and are retained phonetically, as is standard for such ritual formulas.

The passage identifies the past-life sage with Śākyamuni, Śakra with the former companion, and Śacikā with the mother — a classic Buddha-biography past-life revelation (jātaka-style) embedded in a tantra or dhāraṇī text. The text appears to be a recension of the Aparimitāyur-sūtra or a closely related longevity dhāraṇī cycle.

- The four Tathāgatas indicated by cardinal direction are Akṣobhya in the east, Ratnasambhava in the south, Amitābha in the west, and Amoghasiddhi in the north — identified through their directional assignments and epithets rather than being named explicitly in the Tibetan. The rendering of their epithets follows this identification.

- The opening verse concerning those who dwell in fear of the Lord of Death with serpents refers to initiates being led into the maṇḍala as part of the empowerment ceremony, with the protective serpent imagery evoking the terror of death that the practice overcomes.

The phrase rendered "recite the mantra continuously through the night without pause" translates a Tibetan expression meaning literally "to recite hitting the mark of the name, cutting off from a distance" — a technical instruction for uninterrupted, focused nocturnal recitation; the rendering captures the functional intent.

The list of substances for the sādhana reflects the full range of substances used in different classes of practice, including transgressive substances such as blood and flesh; this is characteristic of Vajrayāna ritual contexts and is rendered literally without softening.

- The four great kings are the four guardian kings of the directions: Vaiśravaṇa (north, king of yakṣas), Dhṛtarāṣṭra (east, king of gandharvas), Virūḍhaka (south, king of kumbhāṇḍas), and Virūpākṣa (west, king of nāgas). Their Tibetan epithets — Rnam thos kyi bu, Yul 'khor srung, 'Phags skyes po, and Mig mi bzang — are rendered by their Sanskrit names throughout for

consistency with the textual tradition.

The phrase rendered "standing proud" for the Tibetan term meaning "in a posture of confident display" reflects an iconographic convention; the Tibetan implies a particular martial or triumphant standing posture.

- The ten seed-syllable mantra strings are transliterated as they appear in the Tibetan; they are esoteric essence-syllables and are left as liturgical text without translation, as is standard practice.

The phrase rendered "held to account before Vajrapāṇi" reflects the Tibetan idiom of being subject to Vajrapāṇi's sanction as enforcer of oath-keeping in tantric and ritual contexts.

- The "lord of all spirits, Vaiśravaṇa" in the third paragraph is a distinct figure from Kubera introduced at the passage's end in the preceding translation; the Tibetan here uses "dbaṅ Idan" as a name or epithet (Vaiśravaṇa, the yakṣa king who is also Kubera). The continuity of Kubera's speech flows directly into Vaiśravaṇa's speech in the Tibetan, and the two should be understood as the same deity, the great king of yakṣas, speaking further. The rendering here follows the Tibetan's own structuring.

The phrase "those who have taken birth a second time" renders the Tibetan idiom for twice-born, referring to the brahmin, warrior, and householder castes of classical South Asian society who undergo a second birth through initiation rites.

The eight planetary seed-syllables are left as transcribed since they are mantra-syllables without lexical meaning to render.

"Red-eyed one" in the verse likely refers to Mars; "the direction of the rākṣasas" is the southwest in classical Indian cosmology; "the direction of Vaiśravaṇa" is the north.

- The term "phud" appearing several times is a ritual offering-word of obscure but specialized Indic origin, functioning as a conventional formula for making the first offering or libation in a rite. It is here transliterated rather than translated, as it functions as a ritual exclamation rather than a semantically transparent word.

The nāga names in the maṇḍala description correspond to the canonical eight great nāga kings: Ananta (འནཏ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་), Karkoṭaka (ཀ་ར་ཀོ་ཏ་ཀ་), Kulika (ཀུ་ལི་ཀ་), Vasuki (བ་སུ་གྲི་པ་ལྷ་མོ་), Śaṅkhaṇḍa (ཤ་མཁ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་), Padma (པ་དྲ་མོ་), and Varuṇa (བ་ར་ཀྲ་ལྷ་མོ་), with one partially merged in the verse due to metrical constraints. The identification follows the standard eight-nāga-king lists of Buddhist iconography.

- The mantras beginning "Om bhairava bhī svāhā" follow Sanskrit phonology consistent with Bhairava (a wrathful form closely linked to Śiva) invocation sequences; the syllable series bha, bhi, bhū, bhe, bhai, bhau, bhaṃ, bhaḥ represents a standard vowel progression on the root syllable. The Tibetan "འཇམ་མཐོག་པུ་ལྷ་མོ་འཇམ་མཐོག་པུ་ལྷ་མོ་" (Great Terrifier) and "འཇམ་མཐོག་པུ་ལྷ་མོ་འཇམ་མཐོག་པུ་ལྷ་མོ་" (Great Bhairava) are being used interchangeably for what is technically the deity Mahābhairava, a fierce aspect closely associated with Śiva incorporated into the Buddhist tantric pantheon; the rendering "Great Terrifier" is chosen to remain transparent to listeners unfamiliar with Bhairava.

The term "Phud" (Tibetan: ཕུད་) is a technical mantra-syllable name used in this ritual context rather than a translatable word; it is left as such.

The passage ends mid-sentence in the Tibetan as given, suggesting the source text continues beyond the provided excerpt.

- The phrase rendered "the drink that overflows with seminal fluid" follows the tantric ritual register; the Tibetan "khu ba bro ba'i btung ba" literally means "the drink that exudes or oozes seminal fluid," a term belonging to the antinomian offering substances of inner tantra. This is

preserved without softening as it reflects the doctrinal content.

The gods' heart-essence syllables (Om̐ Ā, Om̐ Bhi, etc.) are phonetic transcriptions of Sanskrit seed-syllables; their exact canonical Sanskrit reconstruction is uncertain and they are rendered as given in the Tibetan phonetic form.

The opening verse segment continues the preceding passage mid-sentence, as the continuity instruction indicates; the connection "surrounded by eight" refers to the eight fierce goddess-consorts named at the close of the preceding rendered passage.

- The sixfold repetition of motion verbs — stirred, greatly stirred, thoroughly and greatly stirred; shook, greatly shook, thoroughly and greatly shook, and so on — reflects a standard sūtra formula for the six modes of cosmic trembling that signal a momentous spiritual event. It is rendered literally here to preserve the liturgical force of the original. The phrase "the path of arising" renders རྒྱུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་, which could refer to the path leading out of or arising from cyclic existence; the ambiguity is deliberate in such enumerative lists. The term རྒྱུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ is rendered "the state of whatever one desires," reading རྒྱུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ལུ་ as a form of "what one wishes to belong to" or "desired status"; this is somewhat idiomatic and the precise referent is uncertain.

- The passage transitions from mantra-text to ritual instruction and then to a samaya-verse section, all of which belong to a Mahāyāna-Vajrayāna sādhanā text centered on Amitāyus. The mantras are rendered in standard Roman transliteration following Tibetan phonetic spelling; minor variations from Sanskrit orthographic convention are a feature of the Tibetan tantric transmission and are preserved as-is. The final verse is cut off in the source text and the translation reflects that exactly.

The phrase rendered "draws forth from the vajra of body, speech, and mind" refers to the standard tantric notion that the vidyā is extracted from the threefold vajra-nature of all Tathāgatas; no uncertainty attaches to this, but it is worth noting for doctrinal orientation.

The identity-pride formula "ātmako'haṃ" is literally "I myself am he," interpreted here in its tantric sense of identification with the deity's samaya-body; the fuller rendering in parentheses is a gloss for the listener's comprehension, not a deviation from the text.

- The passage contains explicit antinomian instructions characteristic of certain tantric texts, including the taking of wealth, speaking falsehood, and consorting with another's partner, all justified by compassionate intent or ritual context. These are presented here as they stand in the source text, framed within the logic of tantric transgression (samaya-based conduct) and should not be taken as general ethical prescriptions. The translator renders them faithfully without softening.

The phrase rendered "those who sweep" reflects a term for the lowest social rank, those who performed sweeping as a menial caste duty; this is a social marker, not a moral judgment in context.

The mantras are rendered as they appear in the Tibetan phonetic transcription of Sanskrit; they are liturgical and have not been normalized to classical Sanskrit orthography, as the source itself preserves a Tibetan phonetic approximation.

- The passage contains a list of fire-offering pit dimensions that presents some difficulty. The Tibetan gives "khru gang" (one cubit), "khru do" (two cubits), and "khru bzhi pa" (four cubits) as the lowest, middle, and best sizes for the round peaceful fire pit, and later "khru do pa'am khru bzhi pa" with "khru brgyad pa" as the supreme — these appear to be a graduated series for the square (wrathful or prosperity) pit. The translation renders these literally as the most defensible reading given the ritual context.

The phrase rendered "birds" in the offering list likely refers to bird-shaped offering vessels or figures, a standard ritual item, rather than living birds.

- The final sentence is syntactically incomplete in the source, breaking off mid-request. The passage ends with a subordinate clause, suggesting either a page break or textual lacuna at this point; the translation preserves this incompleteness faithfully.

The phrase rendered "examination king" refers to the title of the text or scripture under discussion, a vidyārāja-type ritual compendium; the Tibetan "brtag pa'i rgyal po" literally means "king of examination" or "investigative king," functioning here as a proper title of the tantra being praised.

- The verse section describing the maṇḍala layout uses honorific epithets for the directional figures that I have rendered functionally: "one holding a jewel in his right hand" indicates Ratnapāṇi (east or south), "the lotus-holder" indicates Padmapāṇi or Avalokiteśvara (west), and "one holding a sword" indicates Mañjuśrī or a similar figure (north). The text does not name these figures explicitly in this verse, so I have rendered the descriptions literally rather than supplying names not present in the Tibetan.

The passage ends mid-sentence on the qualities of the qualified mantra-master, indicating the text continues beyond this excerpt.

- The mantra syllables are rendered as they appear in the Tibetan transliteration without alteration, as is standard practice for dhāraṇī and mantra material in tantric texts.

The final verse paragraph breaks off mid-sentence, as the source passage itself is incomplete at that point.

The term rendered "Mahāsukha" translates the Tibetan "bde ba chen po," meaning "great bliss," here functioning as a deity-epithet rather than a doctrinal abstraction; this reading is supported by its parallel construction with "the great body of Samantabhadra."

- The passage presents a sequence of tantric ritual instructions covering activities associated with the midday session, fire-offering, visualization, mantra application, and mudrā. Several deity-names appear: Vijayā is a goddess of victory; Vajrasūrya is a vajra-sun deity; the Lotus-Bearer renders a Padmapāṇi epithet, here likely Avalokiteśvara but functioning generically. The eight planetary lords refers to the eight principal grahas of Indian astrology, associated with inauspicious influences. The syllable Jam causing muteness and the syllables Bām, Hūm, Hām, and Hrīḥ are seed syllables functioning as ritual instruments; their phonetic forms are left untranslated as they are mantra-syllables rather than words. The phrase rendered "the near edge of the sun belonging to oneself" is compressed and somewhat cryptic in the Tibetan; the sense appears to be the concluding period of one's own association with the rising sun, i.e., the early morning sun's edge, consistent with the preceding ritual context.
- The passage is a ritual mudrā manual with extremely terse, list-like descriptions of hand-gestures linked to deities and functions. Several lines are near-formulaic abbreviations whose full execution would require the accompany illustrations or oral instruction.

"Bhr̥dgir̥iti" is a transliteration of what appears to be the Sanskrit name Bhr̥ṅgiriṭi, a skeletal attendant of Śiva. The Tibetan syllables འཕྱུག་པའི་རྒྱུ་ལྷ་མོ་ are a phonetic rendering rather than a translatable term.

The phrase rendered "the remnant planets ever caught in eclipse" follows the Tibetan gza' lhag rtag tu se gol gtogs, which likely refers to the eclipse-causing planets Rāhu and Ketu (the "remainder" nodes of the lunar cycle) always associated with devouring or seizing — a technical Indic astronomical allusion.

- The long syllable-repetition sequences (sa sa sa..., ba ba ba..., dzra dzra dzra..., twa twa twa...) are ritual seed-syllable chains for drum-beating or hand-striking patterns, and have

been rendered as transliterated phonetics, which is the only responsible treatment for text-to-speech of material that is essentially musical-phonetic notation rather than semantic language.

The verb-forms describing the mudrās in the middle section involve highly compressed technical terminology relating to the interdigitation and positioning of fingers corresponding to seed-syllables Ā, Om̐, Hūṃ, and Trāṃ. The precise physical execution cannot be recovered from the text alone and would require a living transmission; the translation renders the textual description faithfully without claiming to fully decode the choreography.

The name rendered "Prajñāntakā" for the possessor of the skull-at-mouth mudrā is a reading of རྒྱལ་མཁན་ཀ་, which is an attested Tibetan rendering of that deity's name. Some manuscript traditions may differ.

- [illegible]

The final line is syntactically incomplete in the source passage, ending mid-sentence, and is accordingly translated as such.

- The phrase rendered "the benefactor of beings who abides therein" translates a compressed verse line referring to a figure residing on or within the white full moon; the precise identity of this figure is contextually implied by the preceding visualization instructions and is consistent with the practice lineage's understanding of the central deity being invited.

The term "milky wood" refers to wood from lactiferous trees (such as fig, banyan, or similar species), a standard fire-offering ingredient in Indian ritual manuals; the Tibetan "zho dang ldan pa" literally means "having milk-sap."

- The phrase rendered "royal banner" in relation to the divine wish-fulfilling jewel follows the Tibetan yid bzhin nor rgyal mtshan, literally "the wish-fulfilling jewel victory-banner," likely a compound epithet of the deity being visualized. The exact referent is somewhat compressed in the verse syntax, and some ambiguity remains about whether this describes a separate visualized object or an epithet of the wrathful deity himself.

The term "vajra-laughter" renders *rdo rje bzhad*, an honorific epithet or possibly a deity name, retained here in descriptive translation as it appears to enumerate distinct figures or qualities adorning the visualization.

- The phrase rendered "grain of long life" translates *skye tshe 'bru*, likely a specific medicinal or ritual grain (possibly interpreted as life-prolonging barley or similar); the exact botanical identification is uncertain. The term *la-phug* is a plant species (possibly a variety of radish or tuber) left untranslated as its precise identity is debated among ritual commentators. The phrase "double should be made double" for *nyis 'gyur ba ni nyis 'gyur bya* reflects a terse instruction about doubling measurements and is taken at face value. The "Lotus-Holder" renders *phyag na pad+ma*, an epithet of Avalokiteśvara here used in a tantric context alongside *Vajrapāṇi*.
- The "Sinuous Lady" and "Joyful Lady" render two feminine deity epithets whose precise identities are not entirely fixed in this context; they appear to be consort or attendant figures associated with the subjugation rite.

The phrase rendered "the bearer of the makara banner" refers to a figure whose banner is adorned with a makara (sea monster), an emblem frequently associated with Kāma, the god of desire, here functioning as a subjugation deity within the mandala.

The red cord that must not be cut is a standard ritual element in subjugation rites, signifying unbroken connection between practitioner and the visualized deity or target.

The passage "by the nature of mind he has no body" reflects a Mahāyāna doctrinal overlay on the fierce deity's praise: his wrathful form is ultimately empty of inherent existence, and his activities arise from the non-conceptual wisdom mind rather than a solidly real body.

- The final sentence breaks off mid-passage, ending abruptly with "all lower realms" — this reflects the source text as given, which ends mid-sentence at a page or section boundary. The term "gandharvas" renders Tibetan *dri za*, fragrance-eaters, the celestial musicians of Indian cosmology. The verse section is densely paradoxical and appears to describe a wrathful-yet-enlightened deity in the tantric register, likely Vajrapāṇi or a cognate figure; the play between conventional attributes such as desire, aversion, and delusion and their purified or transmuted forms is a standard tantric rhetorical device and is rendered literally as the text intends.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.